THE THIRD ANGEL'S MESSAGE



Third Quarter 2026

WEEKLY TOPICS

I. A WORK OF RESTORATION

II. THE THIRD ANGEL AND HIS MESSAGE

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A WORK OF RESTORATION

June 28 – July 4, 2026



KEY TEXT

“And he that sat upon the throne said, Behold, I make all things new. And he said unto me, ‘Write: for these words are true and faithful.’” Revelation 21:5

INTRODUCTION

“In the time of the end, every divine institution is to be restored.” Prophets and Kings, 678

Study Help: Prophets and Kings, 677, 678; Selected Messages, Book 1, 236–241

ALL THINGS MADE NEW

SUNDAY
28 June

What is God’s purpose for our fallen world —the one world in rebellion? Luke 19:10; Matthew 19:29

Luke 19:10

For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost.



Matthew 19:29

And every one that hath forsaken houses, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.

That I May Know Him, 291

“Jesus became a man that He might mediate between man and God, … that He might restore to man the original mind which he lost in Eden through Satan’s alluring temptation.”

The Review and Herald, August 21, 1888

“We can see in the cross of Calvary what it has cost the Son of God to bring salvation to a fallen race. As the sacrifice in behalf of man was complete, so the restoration of man from the defilement of sin must be thorough and complete.”

Satan, by means of his success in turning man aside from the path of obedience, became 'the god of this world.' 2 Corinthians 4:4. The dominion that once was Adam's passed to the usurper. But the Son of God proposed to come to this earth to pay the penalty of sin, and thus not only redeem man, but recover the dominion forfeited. It is of this restoration that Micah prophesied.

Prophets and Kings, 682

The Review and Herald, June 7, 1887

“Whatever was lost in the fall of Adam is more than restored in redemption.”



ALL THINGS MADE NEW

SUNDAY
28 June

Describe the specific work of God's people in preparation for Christ's soon return. Revelation 3:18–21; James 1:21–25; Revelation 16:15

Revelation 3:18–21

I counsel thee to buy of me gold tried in the fire, that thou mayest be rich; and white raiment, that thou mayest be clothed, and that the shame of thy nakedness do not appear; and anoint thine eyes with eyesalve, that thou mayest see.

Revelation 3:19–21

As many as I love, I rebuke and chasten: be zealous therefore, and repent. Behold, I stand at the door, and knock: if any man hear my voice, and open the door, I will come in to him, and will sup with him, and he with me. To him that overcometh will I grant to sit with me in my throne, even as I also overcame, and am set down with my Father in his throne.

James 1:21

Wherefore lay apart all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save your souls.

James 1:22, 23

But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves. For if any be a hearer of the word, and not a doer, he is like unto a man beholding his natural face in a glass:

James 1:24, 25

For he beholdeth himself, and goeth his way, and straightway forgetteth what manner of man he was. But whoso looketh into the perfect law of liberty, and continueth therein, he being not a forgetful hearer, but a doer of the work, this man shall be blessed in his deed.

Revelation 16:15

Behold, I come as a thief. Blessed is he that watcheth, and keepeth his garments, lest he walk naked, and they see his shame.

Prophets and Kings, 186, 187

“In the closing work of God in the earth, the standard of His law will be again exalted. False religion may prevail, iniquity may abound, the love of many may wax cold, the cross of Calvary may be lost sight of, and darkness, like the pall of death, may spread over the world;

Prophets and Kings, 186, 187

the whole force of the popular current may be turned against the truth; plot after plot may be formed to overthrow the people of God; but in the hour of greatest peril the God of Elijah will raise up human instrumentalities to bear a message that will not be silenced.”

RESTORATION OF THE LAW

MONDAY
29 June

As far as the law of God is concerned, in what way did Christ start the work of restoration? Isaiah 42:21; Matthew 5:17–20; 22:36–40

Isaiah 42:21

The LORD is well pleased for his righteousness' sake; he will magnify the law, and make it honourable.



Matthew 5:17, 18

Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil. For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled.

Matthew 5:19

Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven: but whosoever shall do and teach them, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven.

Matthew 5:20

For I say unto you, That except your righteousness shall exceed the righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees, ye shall in no case enter into the kingdom of heaven.

Matthew 22:36, 37

Master, which is the great commandment in the law? Jesus said unto him, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.

Matthew 22:38, 39

This is the first and great commandment. And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

Matthew 22:40

On these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets.



The Desire of Ages, 307, 308

“ ‘Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfill.’ Here Jesus refutes the charge of the Pharisees. His mission to the world is to vindicate the sacred claims of that law which they charge Him with breaking.”

The Desire of Ages, 307, 308

“If the law of God could have been changed or abrogated, then Christ need not have suffered the consequences of our transgression. He came to explain the relation of the law to man, and to illustrate its precepts by His own life of obedience.”

RESTORATION OF THE LAW

MONDAY
29 June

Give two examples of how Christ sought to restore the law of God. Matthew 15:3–6; John 7:19. What respect did Christ show for the writings of the Old Testament prophets? Luke 11:28; John 5:46, 47

Matthew 15:3, 4

But he answered and said unto them, Why do ye also transgress the commandment of God by your tradition? For God commanded, saying, Honour thy father and mother: and, He that curseth father or mother, let him die the death.

Matthew 15:5, 6

But ye say, Whosoever shall say to his father or his mother, It is a gift, by whatsoever thou mightest be profited by me; And honour not his father or his mother, he shall be free. Thus have ye made the commandment of God of none effect by your tradition.

John 7:19

Did not Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keepeth the law? Why go ye about to kill me?

Luke 11:28

But he said, Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.

John 5:46, 47

For had ye believed Moses, ye would have believed me: for he wrote of me. But if ye believe not his writings, how shall ye believe my words?

The Desire of Ages, 307

“Christ Himself had given both the moral and the ceremonial law. He did not come to destroy confidence in His own instruction. It was because of His great reverence for the law and the prophets that He sought to break through the wall of traditional requirements which hemmed in the Jews.”

The Desire of Ages, 307

“While He set aside their false interpretations of the law, He carefully guarded His disciples against yielding up the vital truths committed to the Hebrews.”

CALLED TO ESTABLISH THE LAW

TUESDAY
30 June

What law is to be established by Christ's followers under the New Dispensation? Jeremiah 31:31–33; Romans 2:17–27; 3:19, 31

Jeremiah 31:31

Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah:

Jeremiah 31:32

Not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt; which my covenant they brake, although I was an husband unto them, saith the LORD:

Jeremiah 31:33

But this shall be the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel; After those days, saith the LORD, I will put my law in their inward parts, and write it in their hearts; and will be their God, and they shall be my people.

Romans 2:17, 18

Behold, thou art called a Jew, and restest in the law, and makest thy boast of God, And knowest his will, and approvest the things that are more excellent, being instructed out of the law;

Romans 2:19–21

And art confident that thou thyself art a guide of the blind, a light of them which are in darkness, An instructor of the foolish, a teacher of babes, which hast the form of knowledge and of the truth in the law. Thou therefore which teachest another, teachest thou not thyself? thou that preachest a man should not steal, dost thou steal?

Romans 2:22–24

Thou that sayest a man should not commit adultery, dost thou commit adultery? thou that abhorrest idols, dost thou commit sacrilege? Thou that makest thy boast of the law, through breaking the law dishonourest thou God? For the name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles through you, as it is written.

Romans 2:25–27

For circumcision verily profiteth, if thou keep the law: but if thou be a breaker of the law, thy circumcision is made uncircumcision. Therefore if the uncircumcision keep the righteousness of the law, shall not his uncircumcision be counted for circumcision? And shall not uncircumcision which is by nature, if it fulfil the law, judge thee, who by the letter and circumcision dost transgress the law?

Romans 3:19, 31

Now we know that what things soever the law saith, it saith to them who are under the law: that every mouth may be stopped, and all the world may become guilty before God. Do we then make void the law through faith? God forbid: yea, we establish the law.

The Desire of Ages, 309

“The Saviour’s life of obedience maintained the claims of the law; it proved that the law could be kept in humanity, and showed the excellence of character that obedience would develop. All who obey as He did are likewise declaring that the law is ‘holy, and just, and good.’ Romans 7:12.”

The Desire of Ages, 309

“On the other hand, all who break God’s commandments are sustaining Satan’s claim that the law is unjust, and cannot be obeyed. Thus, they second the deceptions of the great adversary, and cast dishonor upon God. They are the children of the wicked one, who was the first rebel against God’s law.”

The Desire of Ages, 309

“To admit them into heaven would again bring in the elements of discord and rebellion, and imperil the well-being of the universe. No man who willfully disregards one principle of the law shall enter the kingdom of heaven.”

CALLED TO ESTABLISH THE LAW

TUESDAY
30 June

Though the law cannot justify (pardon) us, why do we nonetheless need it?
Romans 3:20; 7:7

Romans 3:20

Therefore by the deeds of the law there shall no flesh be justified in his sight: for by the law is the knowledge of sin.

Romans 7:7

What shall we say then? Is the law sin? God forbid. Nay, I had not known sin, but by the law: for I had not known lust, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet.

The Desire of Ages, 308

“When the law was proclaimed from Sinai, God made known to men the holiness of His character, that by contrast they might see the sinfulness of their own. The law was given to convict them of sin, and reveal their need of a Saviour.”

The Desire of Ages, 308

“It would do this as its principles were applied to the heart by the Holy Spirit. This work it is still to do.”

The Desire of Ages, 308

“In the life of Christ, the principles of the law are made plain; and as the Holy Spirit of God touches the heart, as the light of Christ reveals to men their need of His cleansing blood and His justifying righteousness, the law is still an agent in bringing us to Christ, that we may be justified by faith.”

THE ARK OF THE COVENANT IN HEAVEN

WEDNESDAY

1 July

What does the earthly sanctuary with its belongings (Hebrews 9:3, 4) reveal concerning the contents of the ark of the covenant in the heavenly sanctuary? Hebrews 8:1–5

Hebrews 8:1, 2

Now of the things which we have spoken this is the sum: We have such an high priest, who is set on the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens; A minister of the sanctuary, and of the true tabernacle, which the Lord pitched, and not man.

Hebrews 8:3, 4

For every high priest is ordained to offer gifts and sacrifices: wherefore it is of necessity that this man have somewhat also to offer. For if he were on earth, he should not be a priest, seeing that there are priests that offer gifts according to the law:

Hebrews 8:5

Who serve unto the example and shadow of heavenly things, as Moses was admonished of God when he was about to make the tabernacle: for, See, saith he, that thou make all things according to the pattern shewed to thee in the mount.

SDA Commentary, Vol. 7, 972

“Sacrilegious minds and hearts have thought they were mighty enough to change the times and laws of Jehovah; but, safe in the archives of heaven, in the ark of God, are the original commandments, written upon the two tables of stone.”

WEDNESDAY

1 July

THE ARK OF THE COVENANT IN HEAVEN

After the disappointment of 1844, what light did the honest searchers of truth receive concerning the heavenly sanctuary and its contents? Revelation 11:19 (compare Exodus 25:8–10, 16; 31:18)

Revelation 11:19

And the temple of God was opened in heaven, and there was seen in his temple the ark of his testament: and there were lightnings, and voices, and thunderings, and an earthquake, and great hail.

The Great Controversy, 433, 434

“When the temple of God was opened in heaven, the ark of His testament was seen. Within the holy of holies, in the sanctuary in heaven, the divine law is sacredly enshrined —the law that was spoken by God Himself amid the thunders of Sinai and written with His own finger on the tables of stone.”

The Great Controversy, 433, 434

“The law of God in the sanctuary in heaven is the great original, of which the precepts inscribed upon the tables of stone and recorded by Moses in the Pentateuch were an unerring transcript.”

The Great Controversy, 433, 434

“Those who arrived at an understanding of this important point were thus led to see the sacred, unchanging character of the divine law. They saw, as never before, the force of the Saviour’s words: ‘Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law.’ Matthew 5:18.”

The Great Controversy, 433, 434

“The law of God, being a revelation of His will, a transcript of His character, must forever endure, ‘as a faithful witness in heaven.’ Not one command has been annulled; not a jot or tittle has been changed.”

THURSDAY
2 July

THE MEASURING PROCESS

To what work should we pay much attention since the heavenly sanctuary has been opened to our understanding in these last days? Revelation 11:1; Ecclesiastes 12:13, 14

Revelation 11:1

And there was given me a reed like unto a rod: and the angel stood, saying, Rise, and measure the temple of God, and the altar, and them that worship therein.

Ecclesiastes 12:13, 14

Let us hear the conclusion of the whole matter: Fear God, and keep his commandments: for this is the whole duty of man. For God shall bring every work into judgment, with every secret thing, whether it be good, or whether it be evil.

Here is the work going on, measuring the temple and its worshipers to see who will stand in the last day. Those who stand fast shall have an abundant entrance into the kingdom of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 972

When we are doing our work remember there is One that is watching the spirit in which we are doing it. Shall we not bring the Saviour into our everyday lives, into our secular work and domestic duties?

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 972

Then in the name of God we want to leave behind everything that is not necessary, all gossiping or unprofitable visiting, and present ourselves as servants of the living God.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 972

THURSDAY
2 July

THE MEASURING PROCESS

What is the rod by which we are measured? Romans 2:12; James 2:10–12. What call comes to every sinner while Christ is in the sanctuary? Isaiah 55:6, 7; Hebrews 7:25

Romans 2:12

For as many as have sinned without law shall also perish without law: and as many as have sinned in the law shall be judged by the law;

James 2:10–12

For whosoever shall keep the whole law, and yet offend in one point, he is guilty of all. For he that said, Do not commit adultery, said also, Do not kill. Now if thou commit no adultery, yet if thou kill, thou art become a transgressor of the law.So speak ye, and so do, as they that shall be judged by the law of liberty.

Isaiah 55:6, 7

Seek ye the LORD while he may be found, call ye upon him while he is near: Let the wicked forsake his way, and the unrighteous man his thoughts: and let him return unto the LORD, and he will have mercy upon him; and to our God, for he will abundantly pardon.

Hebrews 7:25

Wherefore he is able also to save them to the uttermost that come unto God by him, seeing he ever liveth to make intercession for them.

The grand judgment is taking place, and has been going on for some time. Now the Lord says, Measure the temple and the worshipers thereof. Remember when you are walking the streets about your business, God is measuring you.

Seventh-day Adventist Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 972

In all our acts of true devotion, we fix our eye of faith upon our Advocate, who is standing between man and the eternal throne, waiting to meet our every effort, and by His Spirit assist us to a more perfect knowledge of God.

Seventh-day Adventist Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 948

REVIEW QUESTIONS

June 28 – July 4, 2026

1. In what aspect of Christ’s work are we to take part?
2. How did Christ vindicate the authority of His law while on earth?
3. Name some vital points which we should understand about God’s law.
4. What must we realize about the ark of the covenant in heaven?
5. In what sense should our attention continually focus on that ark?

THE THIRD ANGEL AND HIS MESSAGE

July 5 – 11, 2026



KEY TEXT

“Here is the patience of the saints: here are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of Jesus.” Revelation 14:12

INTRODUCTION

“Prophecy brings to view a class that, as the result of the threefold message, are keeping the commandments of God.” The Great Controversy, 437

Study Help: The Desire of Ages, 634–636; Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 6, 14–22

THE BEGINNING OF THE END

SUNDAY
5 July

What messages mark the beginning of the work of restoration before the coming of Christ? Revelation 14:6–11

Revelation 14:6

And I saw another angel fly in the midst of heaven, having the everlasting gospel to preach unto them that dwell on the earth, and to every nation, and kindred, and tongue, and people,

Revelation 14:7

Saying with a loud voice, Fear God, and give glory to him; for the hour of his judgment is come: and worship him that made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and the fountains of waters.

Revelation 14:8

And there followed another angel, saying, Babylon is fallen, is fallen, that great city, because she made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her fornication.

Revelation 14:9

And the third angel followed them, saying with a loud voice, If any man worship the beast and his image, and receive his mark in his forehead, or in his hand,

Revelation 14:10

The same shall drink of the wine of the wrath of God, which is poured out without mixture into the cup of his indignation; and he shall be tormented with fire and brimstone in the presence of the holy angels, and in the presence of the Lamb:

Revelation 14:11

And the smoke of their torment ascendeth up for ever and ever: and they have no rest day nor night, who worship the beast and his image, and whosoever receiveth the mark of his name.

To prepare a people to stand in the day of God, a great work of reform was to be accomplished. God saw that many of His professed people were not building for eternity, and in His mercy, He was about to send a message of warning to arouse them from their stupor and lead them to make ready for the coming of the Lord. This warning is brought to view in Revelation 14.”

The Great Controversy, 311

THE BEGINNING OF THE END

SUNDAY
5 July

What will be the result of the proclamation of this message?
Revelation 14:12

Revelation 14:12

Here is the patience of the saints: here are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of Jesus.

Though often in the midst of reproach and persecution, a constant testimony has been borne to the perpetuity of the law of God and the sacred obligation of the creation Sabbath.

The Great Controversy, 453, 454

The Great Controversy, 453, 454

“These truths, as presented in Revelation 14 in connection with ‘the everlasting gospel,’ will distinguish the church of Christ at the time of His appearing. For as the result of the threefold message it is announced: ‘Here are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of Jesus.’ And this message is the last to be given before the coming of the Lord.”

A FITTING REPRESENTATION

MONDAY
6 July

What do the three angels represent?
Zechariah 8:12

Zechariah 8:12

For the seed shall be prosperous; the vine shall give her fruit, and the ground shall give her increase, and the heavens shall give their dew; and I will cause the remnant of this people to possess all these things.

Selected Messages, Book 2, 387

“The angels are represented as flying in the midst of heaven, proclaiming to the world a message of warning, and having a direct bearing upon the people living in the last days of this earth’s history.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 387

“No one hears the voice of these angels, for they are a symbol to represent the people of God who are working in harmony with the universe of heaven. Men and women, enlightened by the Spirit of God and sanctified through the truth, proclaim the three messages in their order.”

A FITTING REPRESENTATION

MONDAY
6 July

What does the third angel of Revelation 14 proclaim? Revelation 14:9–11

Revelation 14:9

And the third angel followed them, saying with a loud voice, If any man worship the beast and his image, and receive his mark in his forehead, or in his hand,

Revelation 14:10

The same shall drink of the wine of the wrath of God, which is poured out without mixture into the cup of his indignation; and he shall be tormented with fire and brimstone in the presence of the holy angels, and in the presence of the Lamb:

Revelation 14:11

And the smoke of their torment ascendeth up for ever and ever: and they have no rest day nor night, who worship the beast and his image, and whosoever receiveth the mark of his name.

The Great Controversy, 432

“[One] class firmly held that the Lord had led them in their past experience; and as they waited and watched and prayed to know the will of God they saw that their great High Priest had entered upon another work of ministration, and, following Him by faith, they were led to see also the closing work of the church.”

The Great Controversy, 432

“They had a clearer understanding of the first and second angels’ messages, and were prepared to receive and give to the world the solemn warning of the third angel of Revelation 14.”

THE SCOPE OF THE MESSAGE

TUESDAY
7 July

What prophetic description fits the popular churches today? 2 Timothy 3:1–5, 7. Since the law of God has been trampled underfoot, what is the scope of the third angel's message in the world?

2 Timothy 3:1, 2

This know also, that in the last days perilous times shall come. For men shall be lovers of their own selves, covetous, boasters, proud, blasphemers, disobedient to parents, unthankful, unholy,

2 Timothy 3:3, 4

Without natural affection, trucebreakers, false accusers, incontinent, fierce, despisers of those that are good, Traitors, heady, highminded, lovers of pleasures more than lovers of God;

2 Timothy 3:5, 7

Having a form of godliness, but denying the power thereof: from such turn away.

Ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth.

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 6, 19

“The Lord God of heaven will not send upon the world His judgments for disobedience and transgression until He has sent His watchmen to give the warning. He will not close up the period of probation until the message shall be more distinctly proclaimed.”

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 6, 19

“The law of God is to be magnified; its claims must be presented in their true, sacred character, that the people may be brought to decide for or against the truth. Yet the work will be cut short in righteousness.”

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 6, 19

“The message of Christ’s righteousness is to sound from one end of the earth to the other to prepare the way of the Lord. This is the glory of God, which closes the work of the third angel.”

THE SCOPE OF THE MESSAGE

TUESDAY
7 July

How will history be repeated? Acts 2:21

Acts 2:21

And it shall come to pass, that whosoever shall call on the name of the Lord shall be saved.

The Desire of Ages, 634

“God has always given men warning of coming judgments. Those who had faith in His message for their time, and who acted out their faith, in obedience to His commandments, escaped the judgments that fell upon the disobedient and unbelieving.”

The Desire of Ages, 634

“The word came to Noah, ‘Come thou and all thy house into the ark; for thee have I seen righteous before Me.’ Noah obeyed and was saved.”

The Desire of Ages, 634

“The message came to Lot, ‘Up, get you out of this place; for the Lord will destroy this city.’ Genesis 7:1; 19:14. Lot placed himself under the guardianship of the heavenly messengers, and was saved.”

The Desire of Ages, 634

“So, Christ’s disciples were given warning of the destruction of Jerusalem. Those who watched for the sign of the coming ruin, and fled from the city, escaped the destruction.”

The Desire of Ages, 634

“So now we are given warning of Christ’s second coming and of the destruction to fall upon the world. Those who heed the warning will be saved.”

THE LAST MESSAGE AND MESSENGERS

WEDNESDAY

8 July

What is the object of the message of Revelation 14 within the church?
Malachi 3:2; Revelation 3:18–20

Malachi 3:2

But who may abide the day of his coming? and who shall stand when he appeareth? for he is like a refiner's fire, and like fullers' soap:

Revelation 3:18

I counsel thee to buy of me gold tried in the fire, that thou mayest be rich; and white raiment, that thou mayest be clothed, and that the shame of thy nakedness do not appear; and anoint thine eyes with eyesalve, that thou mayest see.

Revelation 3:19, 20

As many as I love, I rebuke and chasten: be zealous therefore, and repent. Behold, I stand at the door, and knock: if any man hear my voice, and open the door, I will come in to him, and will sup with him, and he with me.

The Great Controversy, 425

“Those who are living upon the earth when the intercession of Christ shall cease in the sanctuary above are to stand in the sight of a holy God without a mediator. Their robes must be spotless, their characters must be purified from sin by the blood of sprinkling.”

The Great Controversy, 425

“Through the grace of God and their own diligent effort they must be conquerors in the battle with evil.”

The Great Controversy, 425

“While the investigative judgment is going forward in heaven, while the sins of penitent believers are being removed from the sanctuary, there is to be a special work of purification, of putting away of sin, among God’s people upon earth. This work is more clearly presented in the messages of Revelation 14.”

THE LAST MESSAGE AND MESSENGERS

WEDNESDAY

8 July

What is the evidence that this message is the last warning to be given to the world before the end? Revelation 14:14, 15

Revelation 14:14

And I looked, and behold a white cloud, and upon the cloud one sat like unto the Son of man, having on his head a golden crown, and in his hand a sharp sickle.

Revelation 14:14, 15

And another angel came out of the temple, crying with a loud voice to him that sat on the cloud, Thrust in thy sickle, and reap: for the time is come for thee to reap; for the harvest of the earth is ripe.

When Christ entered the most holy place of the heavenly sanctuary to perform the closing work of the atonement, He committed to His servants the last message of mercy to be given to the world. Such is the warning of the third angel of Revelation 14. Immediately following its proclamation, the Son of man is seen by the prophet coming in glory to reap the harvest of the earth.

The Spirit of Prophecy, Vol. 4, 273

Evangelism, 48

“We are nearing the close of this earth’s history. We have before us a great work—the closing work of giving the last warning message to a sinful world. There are men who will be taken from the plow, from the vineyard, from various other branches of work, and sent forth by the Lord to give this message to the world.”

Evangelism, 48

“The world is out of joint. As we look at the picture, the outlook seems discouraging. But Christ greets with hopeful assurance the very men and women who cause us discouragement. In them He sees qualifications that will enable them to take a place in His vineyard.”

Evangelism, 48

“If they will constantly be learners, through His providence He will make them men and women fitted to do a work that is not beyond their capabilities; through the impartation of the Holy Spirit, He will give them power of utterance.”

NO SECOND PROBATION

THURSDAY
9 July

How are we deciding our own destiny as we hear the third angel's message? Deuteronomy 30:19

Deuteronomy 30:19

I call heaven and earth to record this day against you, that I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing: therefore choose life, that both thou and thy seed may live:

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 6, 19

“There is no work in our world so great, so sacred, and so glorious, no work that God honors so much, as this gospel work. The message presented at this time is the last message of mercy for a fallen world. Those who have the privilege of hearing this message, and who persist in refusing to heed the warning, cast away their last hope of salvation. There will be no second probation.”

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 8, 120

“There will be a sharp conflict between those who are loyal to God and those who cast scorn upon His law. Reverence for God’s law has been subverted. The religious leaders are teaching for doctrine the commandments of men. As it was in the days of ancient Israel, so it is in this age of the world.”

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 8, 120

“But because of the prevalence of disloyalty and transgression, will those who have reverenced the law of God now cherish less respect for it? Will they unite with the powers of earth to make it void? The loyal will not be carried away by the current of evil.”

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 8, 120

“They will not throw contempt on that which God has set apart as holy. They will not follow Israel’s example of forgetfulness; they will call to remembrance God’s dealings with His people in all ages, and will walk in the way of His commandments. “The test comes to everyone. There are only two sides. On which side are you?”

NO SECOND PROBATION

THURSDAY
9 July

What is the loud voice of the third angel's message? Acts 2:3, 4, 17. How can we take part in the promised blessing, and what is the next important event? Acts 3:19, 20; Hebrews 9:28

Acts 2:3, 4

And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.

Acts 2:17

And it shall come to pass in the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams:

Acts 3:19, 20

Repent ye therefore, and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out, when the times of refreshing shall come from the presence of the Lord; And he shall send Jesus Christ, which before was preached unto you:

Hebrews 9:28

So Christ was once offered to bear the sins of many; and unto them that look for him shall he appear the second time without sin unto salvation.

Testimonies, Vol. 5, 252

“The Spirit which characterized that wonderful meeting on the Day of Pentecost is waiting to manifest its power upon the men who are now standing between the living and the dead as ambassadors for God. The power which stirred the people so mightily in the 1844 movement will again be revealed. The third angel’s message will go forth, not in whispered tones, but with a loud voice.”

It is ‘unto them that look for Him’ that Christ is to ‘appear the second time without sin unto salvation.’ Hebrews 9:28.

The Great Controversy, 315

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. What is to distinguish Christ's true church at His coming?
2. Who is the third angel, and what is his message?
3. How is Bible history soon to be repeated?
4. What responsibilities rest upon all who hear this vital message?
5. What should strengthen us in sharing the third angel's message?

SABBATH-KEEPING, A TEST OF LOYALTY

July 12 – 18, 2026



KEY TEXT

“Moreover also I gave them My sabbaths, to be a sign between Me and them, that they might know that I am the LORD that sanctify them.”
Ezekiel 20:12

INTRODUCTION

“As a sign of His sanctifying power, the Sabbath is given to all who through Christ become a part of the Israel of God.” The Desire of Ages, 288

Study Help: The Desire of Ages, 281–289; The Great Controversy, 49–54

LEARNING FROM CHRIST

SUNDAY
12 July

What is the evidence that the Sabbath was not made only for the Jews? Genesis 2:1–3; Mark 2:27 How did Christ illustrate correct (or lawful) Sabbath-keeping? Matthew 12:1–13; Luke 13:10–17

Genesis 2:1–3

Thus the heavens and the earth were finished, and all the host of them. And on the seventh day God ended his work which he had made; and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had made. And God blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it: because that in it he had rested from all his work which God created and made.

Mark 2:27

And he said unto them, The sabbath was made for man, and not man for the sabbath:

Matthew 12:1, 2

At that time Jesus went on the sabbath day through the corn; and his disciples were an hungred, and began to pluck the ears of corn, and to eat. But when the Pharisees saw it, they said unto him, Behold, thy disciples do that which is not lawful to do upon the sabbath day.

Matthew 12:3, 4

But he said unto them, Have ye not read what David did, when he was an hungred, and they that were with him; How he entered into the house of God, and did eat the shewbread, which was not lawful for him to eat, neither for them which were with him, but only for the priests?

Matthew 12:5 - 7

Or have ye not read in the law, how that on the sabbath days the priests in the temple profane the sabbath, and are blameless? But I say unto you, That in this place is one greater than the temple. But if ye had known what this meaneth, I will have mercy, and not sacrifice, ye would not have condemned the guiltless.

Matthew 12:8–10

For the Son of man is Lord even of the sabbath day. And when he was departed thence, he went into their synagogue: And, behold, there was a man which had his hand withered. And they asked him, saying, Is it lawful to heal on the sabbath days? that they might accuse him.

Matthew 12:11, 12

And he said unto them, What man shall there be among you, that shall have one sheep, and if it fall into a pit on the sabbath day, will he not lay hold on it, and lift it out? How much then is a man better than a sheep? Wherefore it is lawful to do well on the sabbath days.

Matthew 12:13

Then saith he to the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it forth; and it was restored whole, like as the other.

Luke 13:10, 11

And he was teaching in one of the synagogues on the sabbath. And, behold, there was a woman which had a spirit of infirmity eighteen years, and was bowed together, and could in no wise lift up herself.

Luke 13:12, 13

And when Jesus saw her, he called her to him, and said unto her, Woman, thou art loosed from thine infirmity. And he laid his hands on her: and immediately she was made straight, and glorified God.

Luke 13:14

And the ruler of the synagogue answered with indignation, because that Jesus had healed on the sabbath day, and said unto the people, There are six days in which men ought to work: in them therefore come and be healed, and not on the sabbath day.

Luke 13:15, 16

The Lord then answered him, and said, Thou hypocrite, doth not each one of you on the sabbath loose his ox or his ass from the stall, and lead him away to watering? And ought not this woman, being a daughter of Abraham, whom Satan hath bound, lo, these eighteen years, be loosed from this bond on the sabbath day?

Luke 13:17

And when he had said these things, all his adversaries were ashamed: and all the people rejoiced for all the glorious things that were done by him.

The Desire of Ages, 204

“The Jews had so perverted the law that they made it a yoke of bondage. Their meaningless requirements had become a byword among other nations. Especially was the Sabbath hedged in by all manner of senseless restrictions. It was not to them a delight, the holy of the Lord, and honorable.”

The Desire of Ages, 204

“The scribes and Pharisees had made its observance an intolerable burden. A Jew was not allowed to kindle a fire nor even to light a candle on the Sabbath. As a consequence, the people were dependent upon the Gentiles for many services which their rules forbade them to do for themselves.”

The Desire of Ages, 204

“They did not reflect that if these acts were sinful, those who employed others to perform them were as guilty as if they had done the work themselves. They thought that salvation was restricted to the Jews, and that the condition of all others, being already hopeless, could be made no worse.”

LEARNING FROM CHRIST

SUNDAY
12 July

Explain why the Jews had no valid proof to accuse Jesus of breaking the Sabbath. Luke 6:6–11; Matthew 26:59, 60; John 15:10; John 8:46

Luke 6:6, 7

And it came to pass also on another sabbath, that he entered into the synagogue and taught: and there was a man whose right hand was withered. And the scribes and Pharisees watched him, whether he would heal on the sabbath day; that they might find an accusation against him.

Luke 6:8, 9

But he knew their thoughts, and said to the man which had the withered hand, Rise up, and stand forth in the midst. And he arose and stood forth. Then said Jesus unto them, I will ask you one thing; Is it lawful on the sabbath days to do good, or to do evil? to save life, or to destroy it?

Luke 6:10, 11

And looking round about upon them all, he said unto the man, Stretch forth thy hand. And he did so: and his hand was restored whole as the other. And they were filled with madness; and communed one with another what they might do to Jesus.

Matthew 26:59, 60

Now the chief priests, and elders, and all the council, sought false witness against Jesus, to put him to death; But found none: yea, though many false witnesses came, yet found they none. At the last came two false witnesses,

John 15:10

If ye keep my commandments, ye shall abide in my love; even as I have kept my Father's commandments, and abide in his love.

John 8:46

He that is of God heareth God's words: ye therefore hear them not, because ye are not of God.

The Signs of the Times, January 16, 1896

“The Pharisees accused Christ of breaking the Sabbath because He had healed a man upon the Sabbath day; but His words made it evident that He had not violated the command of God.”

The Signs of the Times, January 16, 1896

“He declared that they were ignorant both of the Scriptures and the power of God, and reminded them that if they had known what this meaneth, ‘I will have mercy, and not sacrifice,’ they would not have condemned the guiltless.”

The Signs of the Times, January 16, 1896

“He carried their minds back to the law and to the testimony, to the words which He Himself had spoken when enshrouded in the pillar of cloud, and revealed to them the principles of the law of God. He showed them that to relieve the suffering of either man or beast on the Sabbath day was in harmony with the commandment of God.”

Neither the Saviour nor His followers broke the law of the Sabbath. Christ was a living representative of the law. No violation of its holy precepts was found in His life. Looking upon a nation of witnesses who were seeking occasion to condemn Him, He could say unchallenged, 'Which of you convicteth Me of sin?' John 8:46, R.V.

The Desire of Ages, 287

LEARNING FROM CHRIST'S DISCIPLES

MONDAY
13 July

What was the practice of the disciples whom Christ had instructed by precept and example? Luke 23:54–56. What did He further exhort them to do? Matthew 24:20

Luke 23:54–56

And that day was the preparation, and the sabbath drew on. And the women also, which came with him from Galilee, followed after, and beheld the sepulchre, and how his body was laid. And they returned, and prepared spices and ointments; and rested the sabbath day according to the commandment.

Matthew 24:20

But pray ye that your flight be not in the winter, neither on the sabbath day:

Man has no right nor power to substitute the first day for the seventh. He may pretend to do this; 'nevertheless the foundation of God standeth sure'. The customs and teachings of men will not lessen the claims of the divine law. God has sanctified the seventh day. That specified portion of time, set apart by God Himself for religious worship, continues as sacred today as when first hallowed by our Creator.

The Review and Herald, May 16, 1882

The Desire of Ages, 630

“Christ gave His disciples a sign of the ruin to come on Jerusalem, and He told them how to escape: ‘When ye shall see Jerusalem compassed with armies, then know that the desolation thereof is nigh. Then let them which are in Judea flee to the mountains; and let them which are in the midst of it depart out; and let not them that are in the countries enter thereinto.’”

The Desire of Ages, 630

“‘For these be the days of vengeance, that all things which are written may be fulfilled.’ This warning was given to be heeded forty years after, at the destruction of Jerusalem. The Christians obeyed the warning, and not a Christian perished in the fall of the city.”

LEARNING FROM CHRIST'S DISCIPLES

MONDAY
13 July

Quote more examples proving that the disciples continued keeping the Sabbath even after Christ's resurrection. Acts 16:13; 17:2; 18:4, 11

Acts 16:13

And on the sabbath we went out of the city by a river side, where prayer was wont to be made; and we sat down, and spake unto the women which resorted thither.

Acts 17:2

And Paul, as his manner was, went in unto them, and three sabbath days reasoned with them out of the scriptures,

Acts 18:4, 11

And he reasoned in the synagogue every sabbath, and persuaded the Jews and the Greeks. And he continued there a year and six months, teaching the word of God among them.

In the first centuries, the true Sabbath had been kept by all Christians. They were jealous for the honor of God, and, believing that His law is immutable, they zealously guarded the sacredness of its precepts.

The Great Controversy, 52

A BREACH IN THE LAW OF GOD

TUESDAY
14 July

During the third and fourth centuries of the Christian Era, what breach was made in the law of God? Daniel 7:25

Daniel 7:25

And he shall speak great words against the most High, and shall wear out the saints of the most High, and think to change times and laws: and they shall be given into his hand until a time and times and the dividing of time.

The Great Controversy, 53

“In nearly every council, the Sabbath which God had instituted was pressed down a little lower, while the Sunday was correspondingly exalted. Thus, the pagan festival came finally to be honored as a divine institution, while the Bible Sabbath was pronounced a relic of Judaism.”

A BREACH IN THE LAW OF GOD

TUESDAY
14 July

What work of repair is to be accomplished in these last days and by whom? Isaiah 58:12

Isaiah 58:12

And they that shall be of thee shall build the old waste places: thou shalt raise up the foundations of many generations; and thou shalt be called, The repairer of the breach, The restorer of paths to dwell in.

Prophets and Kings, 677, 678

“The prophet here describes a people who, in a time of general departure from truth and righteousness, are seeking to restore the principles that are the foundation of the kingdom of God.”

Prophets and Kings, 677, 678

“The breach made in the law at the time the Sabbath was changed by man, is to be repaired. God’s remnant people, standing before the world as reformers,

Prophets and Kings, 677, 678

are to show that the law of God is the foundation of all enduring reform and that the Sabbath of the fourth commandment is to stand as a memorial of creation, a constant reminder of the power of God.”

REPAIRERS OF THE BREACH

Discuss the deeper meaning of "not doing thine own ways, nor finding thine own pleasure, nor speaking thine own words" [Isaiah 58:13] on God's holy day and compare with Exodus 20:8–11 and 1 John 3:22.

Exodus 20:8, 9

Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy. Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work:

Exodus 20:10

But the seventh day is the sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates:

Exodus 20:11

For in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them is, and rested the seventh day: wherefore the LORD blessed the sabbath day, and hallowed it.

1 John 3:22

And whatsoever we ask, we receive of him, because we keep his commandments, and do those things that are pleasing in his sight.

Testimonies, Vol. 2, 584

All who love God should do what they can to make the Sabbath a delight, holy and honorable. They cannot do this by seeking their own pleasure in sinful, forbidden amusements. Yet they can do much to exalt the Sabbath in their families and make it the most interesting day of the week. We should devote time to interesting our children."

Far more sacredness is attached to the Sabbath than is given it by many professed Sabbath-keepers. The Lord has been greatly dishonored by those who have not kept the Sabbath according to the commandment, either in the letter or in the spirit. He calls for a reform in the observance of the Sabbath.

Testimonies, Vol. 6, 353

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 1, 1106

“Every man has been placed on trial, as were Adam and Eve in Eden. As the tree of knowledge was placed in the midst of the garden of Eden, so the Sabbath command is placed in the midst of the decalogue. In regard to the fruit of the tree of knowledge, the restriction was made, ‘Ye shall not eat of it, … lest ye die’ [Genesis 3:3].”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 1, 1106

“Of the Sabbath, God said, Ye shall not defile it, but keep it holy. … As the tree of knowledge was the test of Adam’s obedience, so the fourth command is the test that God has given to prove the loyalty of all His people.”

REPAIRERS OF THE BREACH

WEDNESDAY

15 July

What promises are assured to all restorers of the breach? Isaiah 58:14

Isaiah 58:14

Then shalt thou delight thyself in the LORD; and I will cause thee to ride upon the high places of the earth, and feed thee with the heritage of Jacob thy father: for the mouth of the LORD hath spoken it.

The Desire of Ages, 289

“‘If thou turn away thy foot from the Sabbath, from doing thy pleasure on My holy day; and call the Sabbath a delight, the holy of the Lord, honorable; … then shalt thou delight thyself in the Lord.’ Isaiah 58:13, 14. To all who receive the Sabbath as a sign of Christ’s creative and redeeming power, it will be a delight.”

The Desire of Ages, 289

“Seeing Christ in it, they delight themselves in Him. The Sabbath points them to the works of creation as an evidence of His mighty power in redemption. While it calls to mind the lost peace of Eden, it tells of peace restored through the Saviour. And every object in nature repeats His invitation, ‘Come unto Me, all ye that labor and are heavy-laden, and I will give you Rest.’ Matthew 11:28.”

ENTERING INTO SPIRITUAL REST

THURSDAY
16 July

Sabbath-keeping is an outward sign of what rest? Ezekiel 20:12; Matthew 11:28–30; Hebrews 4:3–6, 9–11

Ezekiel 20:12

Moreover also I gave them my sabbaths, to be a sign between me and them, that they might know that I am the LORD that sanctify them.

Matthew 11:28–30

Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls. For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.

Hebrews 4:3, 4

For we which have believed do enter into rest, as he said, As I have sworn in my wrath, if they shall enter into my rest: although the works were finished from the foundation of the world. For he spake in a certain place of the seventh day on this wise, And God did rest the seventh day from all his works.

Hebrews 4:5, 6

And in this place again, If they shall enter into my rest. Seeing therefore it remaineth that some must enter therein, and they to whom it was first preached entered not in because of unbelief:

Hebrews 4:9–11

There remaineth therefore a rest to the people of God. For he that is entered into his rest, he also hath ceased from his own works, as God did from his. Let us labour therefore to enter into that rest, lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 928

"'There remaineth therefore a rest to the people of God. ... Let us labor therefore to enter into that rest, lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief.' Hebrews 4:9, 11. The rest here spoken of is the rest of grace, obtained by following the prescription, Labor diligently."

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 928

“Those who learn of Jesus His meekness and lowliness find rest in the experience of practicing His lessons. It is not in indolence, in selfish ease and pleasure-seeking, that rest is obtained.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 928

“Those who are unwilling to give the Lord faithful, earnest, loving service will not find spiritual rest in this life or in the life to come. Only from earnest labor comes peace and joy in the Holy Spirit—happiness on earth and glory hereafter.”

ENTERING INTO SPIRITUAL REST

THURSDAY
16 July

What place will the Sabbath of the Lord occupy when the work of restoration is completed? Isaiah 66:23

Isaiah 66:23

And it shall come to pass, that from one new moon to another, and from one sabbath to another, shall all flesh come to worship before me, saith the LORD.

When there shall be a ‘restitution of all things, which God hath spoken by the mouth of all His holy prophets since the world began’ (Acts 3:21), the creation Sabbath, the day on which Jesus lay at rest in Joseph’s tomb, will still be a day of rest and rejoicing. Heaven and earth will unite in praise, as ‘from one Sabbath to another’ (Isaiah 66:23) the nations of the saved shall bow in joyful worship to God and the Lamb.

The Desire of Ages, 769, 770

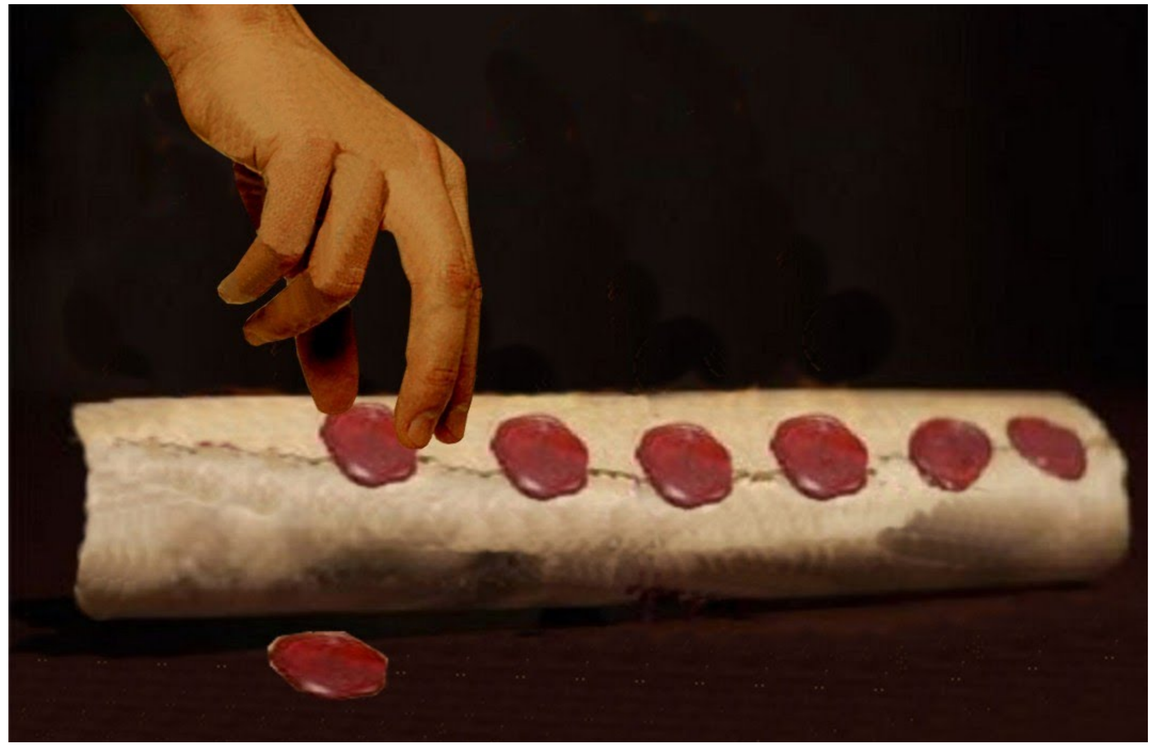
REVIEW QUESTIONS

July 12 – 18, 2026

1. How did Christ exalt the seventh-day Sabbath when on earth?
2. When confronted by those who claim that the early disciples kept Sunday, what Scriptural evidence must we present to them?
3. How are we restoring the memorial of God’s creation today?
4. What is God’s promise to the repairers of the breach?
5. How can we truly appreciate the spiritual nature of the Sabbath?

THE SEALING WORK

July 19 – 25, 2026



KEY TEXT

“Bind up the testimony, seal the law among my disciples.” Isaiah 8:16

INTRODUCTION

“Those who belong to the Lord’s kingdom must work earnestly for the saving of souls. They must do their part to bind up the law and seal it among the disciples.” Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 6, 332

Study Help: Seventh-day Adventist Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 978–982; Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 5, 207–216

THE SEAL OF GOD IS RECOVERED

SUNDAY
19 July

What is the seal of God and where is it found? Exodus 20:8–11. Among whom is the seal of God to be restored and how? Isaiah 8:16

Exodus 20:8, 9

Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy. Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work:

Exodus 20:10

But the seventh day is the sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates: 11

Exodus 20:11

For in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them is, and rested the seventh day: wherefore the LORD blessed the sabbath day, and hallowed it.

Isaiah 8:16

Bind up the testimony, seal the law among my disciples.

The Great Controversy, 452

“The seal of God’s law is found in the fourth commandment. This only, of all the ten, brings to view both the name and the title of the Lawgiver. It declares Him to be the Creator of the heavens and the earth, and thus shows His claim to reverence and worship above all others.”

The Great Controversy, 452

“Aside from this precept, there is nothing in the Decalogue to show by whose authority the law is given. When the Sabbath was changed by the papal power, the seal was taken from the law.”

The Great Controversy, 452

“The disciples of Jesus are called upon to restore it by exalting the Sabbath of the fourth commandment to its rightful position as the Creator’s memorial and the sign of His authority.”

THE SEAL OF GOD IS RECOVERED

SUNDAY
19 July

How can we be sure that this restoration is to be carried on in the Christian Era? Compare Isaiah 8:16 with 1 Peter 2:7–9

1 Peter 2:7

Unto you therefore which believe he is precious: but unto them which be disobedient, the stone which the builders disallowed, the same is made the head of the corner,

1 Peter 2:8

And a stone of stumbling, and a rock of offence, even to them which stumble at the word, being disobedient: whereunto also they were appointed.

1 Peter 2:9

But ye are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, an holy nation, a peculiar people; that ye should shew forth the praises of him who hath called you out of darkness into his marvellous light:

A VISIBLE SIGN OF DISTINCTION

MONDAY
20 July

How were the Israelites distinguished from the idolaters after their deliverance from Egypt? Exodus 31:13–17

Exodus 31:13

Speak thou also unto the children of Israel, saying, Verily my sabbaths ye shall keep: for it is a sign between me and you throughout your generations; that ye may know that I am the LORD that doth sanctify you.

Exodus 31:14

Ye shall keep the sabbath therefore; for it is holy unto you: every one that defileth it shall surely be put to death: for whosoever doeth any work therein, that soul shall be cut off from among his people.

Exodus 31:15, 16

Six days may work be done; but in the seventh is the sabbath of rest, holy to the LORD: whosoever doeth any work in the sabbath day, he shall surely be put to death. Wherefore the children of Israel shall keep the sabbath, to observe the sabbath throughout their generations, for a perpetual covenant.

Exodus 31:17

It is a sign between me and the children of Israel for ever: for in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, and on the seventh day he rested, and was refreshed.

When the Lord delivered His people Israel from Egypt and committed to them His law, He taught them that by the observance of the Sabbath they were to be distinguished from idolaters. It was this that made the distinction between those who acknowledge the sovereignty of God and those who refuse to accept Him as their Creator and King.

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 6, 349

A VISIBLE SIGN OF DISTINCTION

MONDAY
20 July

How are God’s people to be distinguished from the world today? Ezekiel 20:20

Ezekiel 20:20

And hallow my sabbaths; and they shall be a sign between me and you, that ye may know that I am the LORD your God.

Testimonies, Vol. 6, 349, 350

“As the Sabbath was the sign that distinguished Israel when they came out of Egypt to enter the earthly Canaan, so it is the sign that now distinguishes God’s people as they come out from the world to enter the heavenly rest.”

Testimonies, Vol. 6, 349, 350

“The Sabbath is a sign of the relationship existing between God and His people, a sign that they honor His law. It distinguishes between His loyal subjects and transgressors.”

THE WORK OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

TUESDAY
21 July

What invisible power must be working in our life so that we may receive the seal of God? Ephesians 4:30. However, what fruits must be visible? Galatians 5:22, 23

Ephesians 4:30

And grieve not the holy Spirit of God, whereby ye are sealed unto the day of redemption.



Galatians 5:22, 23

But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith, Meekness, temperance: against such there is no law.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 968

“What is the seal of the living God, which is placed in the foreheads of His people? It is a mark which angels, but not human eyes, can read; for the destroying angel must see this mark of redemption. The intelligent mind has seen the sign of the cross of Calvary in the Lord’s adopted sons and daughters.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 968

“The sin of the transgression of the law of God is taken away. They have on the wedding garment, and are obedient and faithful to all God’s commands.”

THE WORK OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

TUESDAY
21 July

How does the Holy Spirit seal a person? John 16:13. And what is the truth? John 17:17; Psalm 119:142

John 16:13

Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come.

John 17:17

Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.



Psalm 119:142

Thy righteousness is an everlasting righteousness, and thy law is the truth.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 980

“The work of the Holy Spirit is to convince the world of sin, of righteousness, and of judgment. The world can only be warned by seeing those who believe the truth sanctified through the truth, acting upon high and holy principles, showing in a high, elevated sense,

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 980

the line of demarcation between those who keep the commandments of God and those who trample them under their feet. The sanctification of the Spirit signalizes the difference between those who have the seal of God and those who keep a spurious rest day."

Just as soon as the people of God are sealed in their foreheads—it is not any seal or mark that can be seen, but a settling into the truth, both intellectually and spiritually, so they cannot be moved—just as soon as God's people are sealed and prepared for the shaking, it will come. Indeed, it has begun already.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 4, 1161

A SPECIAL CLASS

WEDNESDAY
22 July

What are the characteristics of the 144,000 sealed saints?
Revelation 14:1–5, 12; Psalm 15

Revelation 14:1, 2

And I looked, and, lo, a Lamb stood on the mount Sion, and with him an hundred forty and four thousand, having his Father's name written in their foreheads.2 And I heard a voice from heaven, as the voice of many waters, and as the voice of a great thunder: and I heard the voice of harpers harping with their harps:

Revelation 14:3

And they sung as it were a new song before the throne, and before the four beasts, and the elders: and no man could learn that song but the hundred and forty and four thousand, which were redeemed from the earth.

Revelation 14:4

These are they which were not defiled with women; for they are virgins. These are they which follow the Lamb whithersoever he goeth. These were redeemed from among men, being the firstfruits unto God and to the Lamb.

Revelation 14:5

And in their mouth was found no guile: for they are without fault before the throne of God.

Revelation 14:12

Here is the patience of the saints: here are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of Jesus.

Psalm 15:1, 2

LORD, who shall abide in thy tabernacle? who shall dwell in thy holy hill? He that walketh uprightly, and worketh righteousness, and speaketh the truth in his heart.

Psalm 15:3

He that backbiteth not with his tongue, nor doeth evil to his neighbour, nor taketh up a reproach against his neighbour.

Psalm 15:4, 5

In whose eyes a vile person is contemned; but he honoureth them that fear the LORD. He that sweareth to his own hurt, and changeth not. He that putteth not out his money to usury, nor taketh reward against the innocent. He that doeth these things shall never be moved.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 977, 978

"'And I looked, and, lo, a Lamb stood on the Mount Sion, and with Him an hundred forty and four thousand, having His Father's name written in their foreheads. And I heard a voice from heaven, as the voice of many waters, and as the voice of a great thunder: and I heard the voice of harpers harping with their harps:

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 977, 978

and they sung as it were a new song before the throne, and before the four beasts, and the elders: and no man could learn that song but the hundred and forty and four thousand, which were redeemed from the earth. These are they which were not defiled with women; for they are virgins.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 977, 978

“These are they which follow the Lamb whithersoever He goeth. These were redeemed from among men, being the firstfruits unto God and to the Lamb.’ Revelation 14:1–4. This scripture represents the character of the people of God for these last days.”

The mighty power of the Holy Spirit works an entire transformation in the character of the human agent, making him a new creature in Christ Jesus. When a man is filled with the Spirit, the more severely he is tested and tried, the more clearly he proves that he is a representative of Christ.

The Review and Herald, June 10, 1902

The peace that dwells in the soul is seen on the countenance. The words and actions express the love of the Saviour. There is no striving for the highest place. Self is renounced. The name of Jesus is written on all that is said and done.

The Review and Herald, June 10, 1902

We may talk of the blessings of the Holy Spirit, but unless we prepare ourselves for its reception, of what avail are our works? Are we striving with all our power to attain to the stature of men and women in Christ?

The Review and Herald, June 10, 1902

we seeking for His fullness, ever pressing toward the mark set before us—the perfection of His character? When the Lord's people reach this mark, they will be sealed in their foreheads.

The Review and Herald, June 10, 1902

A SPECIAL CLASS

WEDNESDAY

22 July

How many conquerors will there be under the threefold message? Revelation 7:4. Why so few? Luke 13:23–25

Revelation 7:4

And I heard the number of them which were sealed: and there were sealed an hundred and forty and four thousand of all the tribes of the children of Israel.

Luke 13:23, 24

Then said one unto him, Lord, are there few that be saved? And he said unto them, Strive to enter in at the strait gate: for many, I say unto you, will seek to enter in, and shall not be able.

Luke 13:25

When once the master of the house is risen up, and hath shut to the door, and ye begin to stand without, and to knock at the door, saying, Lord, Lord, open unto us; and he shall answer and say unto you, I know you not whence ye are:

The living saints, 144,000 in number, knew and understood the voice [of God], while the wicked thought it was thunder and an earthquake.

Early Writings, 15

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 970

“Only those who receive the seal of the living God will have the passport through the gates of the Holy City. But there are many who take upon themselves responsibilities in connection with the work of God who are not wholehearted believers, and while they remain thus cannot receive the seal of the living God.”

Let us strive with all the power that God has given us to be among the hundred and forty-four thousand.

The Review and Herald, March 9, 1905

A CLEAR DISTINCTION

THURSDAY
23 July

Why will many believers in the third angel’s message be left without the seal of God? Ezekiel 9:2–8; 33:31

Ezekiel 9:2

And, behold, six men came from the way of the higher gate, which lieth toward the north, and every man a slaughter weapon in his hand; and one man among them was clothed with linen, with a writer's inkhorn by his side: and they went in, and stood beside the brasen altar.

Ezekiel 9:3

And the glory of the God of Israel was gone up from the cherub, whereupon he was, to the threshold of the house. And he called to the man clothed with linen, which had the writer's inkhorn by his side;

Ezekiel 9:4, 5

And the LORD said unto him, Go through the midst of the city, through the midst of Jerusalem, and set a mark upon the foreheads of the men that sigh and that cry for all the abominations that be done in the midst thereof. And to the others he said in mine hearing, Go ye after him through the city, and smite: let not your eye spare, neither have ye pity:

Ezekiel 9:6

Slay utterly old and young, both maids, and little children, and women: but come not near any man upon whom is the mark; and begin at my sanctuary. Then they began at the ancient men which were before the house.

Ezekiel 9:7

And he said unto them, Defile the house, and fill the courts with the slain: go ye forth. And they went forth, and slew in the city.

Ezekiel 9:8

And it came to pass, while they were slaying them, and I was left, that I fell upon my face, and cried, and said, Ah Lord GOD! wilt thou destroy all the residue of Israel in thy pouring out of thy fury upon Jerusalem?

Ezekiel 33:31

And they come unto thee as the people cometh, and they sit before thee as my people, and they hear thy words, but they will not do them: for with their mouth they shew much love, but their heart goeth after their covetousness.

Testimonies to Ministers, 445

“Those that overcome the world, the flesh, and the devil, will be the favored ones who shall receive the seal of the living God. Those whose hands are not clean, whose hearts are not pure, will not have the seal of the living God. Those who are planning sin and acting it will be passed by.”

Testimonies to Ministers, 445

“Only those who, in their attitude before God, are filling the position of those who are repenting and confessing their sins in the great antitypical day of atonement, will be recognized and marked as worthy of God’s protection.”

Testimonies to Ministers, 445

“The names of those who are steadfastly looking and waiting and watching for the appearing of their Saviour—more earnestly and wishfully than they who wait for the morning—will be numbered with those who are sealed.”

Testimonies to Ministers, 445

“Those who, while having all the light of truth flashing upon their souls, should have works corresponding to their avowed faith, but are allured by sin, setting up idols in their hearts, corrupting their souls before God, and polluting those who unite with them in sin, will have their names blotted out of the book of life, and be left in midnight darkness, having no oil in their vessels with their lamps.”

Testimonies to Ministers, 445

"'Unto you that fear My name shall the Sun of Righteousness arise with healing in His wings.' Malachi 4:2 "This sealing of the servants of God is the same that was shown to Ezekiel in vision. John also had been a witness of this most startling revelation."

A CLEAR DISTINCTION

What is the great burden of those who will be sealed? Ezekiel 9:4. What separation must be completed before they can receive the seal of God's approval and protection?

Ezekiel 9:4

And the LORD said unto him, Go through the midst of the city, through the midst of Jerusalem, and set a mark upon the foreheads of the men that sigh and that cry for all the abominations that be done in the midst thereof.

Testimonies, Vol. 3, 267

“Who are standing in the counsel of God at this time? Is it those who virtually excuse wrongs among the professed people of God and who murmur in their hearts, if not openly, against those who would reprove sin?”

Testimonies, Vol. 3, 267

“Is it those who take their stand against them and sympathize with those who commit wrong?”

Testimonies, Vol. 3, 267

“No, indeed! Unless they repent, and leave the work of Satan in oppressing those who have the burden of the work and in holding up the hands of sinners in Zion, they will never receive the mark of God’s sealing approval.”

Testimonies, Vol. 3, 267

“They will fall in the general destruction of the wicked, represented by the work of the five men bearing slaughter weapons.”

Testimonies, Vol. 3, 267

“Mark this point with care: Those who receive the pure mark of truth, wrought in them by the power of the Holy Ghost, represented by a mark by the man in linen, are those ‘that sigh and that cry for all the abominations that be done’ in the church.”

Testimonies, Vol. 3, 267

“Their love for purity and the honor and glory of God is such, and they have so clear a view of the exceeding sinfulness of sin, that they are represented as being in agony, even sighing and crying. Read the ninth chapter of Ezekiel.”

The angel is to place a mark upon the forehead of all who are separated from sin and sinners, and the destroying angel will follow, to slay utterly both old and young.

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 5, 505

REVIEW QUESTIONS

July 19 – 25, 2026

1. Why is the Sabbath of the fourth commandment so significant?
2. What does the Sabbath reveal about those who seek to keep it holy?
3. How does the seal of God involve more than just the seventh day?
4. Why will many professing Sabbath keepers be sadly disappointed at the judgment bar of God?
5. In view of this solemn message, what is our responsibility?

THE BEAST OF REVELATION 13

July 26 – August 1, 2026



KEY TEXT

“And out of one of them came forth a little horn, which waxed exceeding great . . . and it cast down the truth to the ground; and it practised, and prospered.” Daniel 8:9, 12

INTRODUCTION

“Romanism as a system is no more in harmony with the gospel of Christ now than at any former period in her history.” The Great Controversy, 565

Study Help: The Great Controversy, 434–439; Selected Messages, Book 2, 367–375

SYMBOLS USED FOR KINGDOMS

SUNDAY
26 July

What symbols are used in the Bible to represent earthly powers? Give examples. Daniel 7:3, 17, 23

Daniel 7:3, 17

And four great beasts came up from the sea, diverse one from another.

These great beasts, which are four, are four kings, which shall arise out of the earth.

Daniel 7:23

Thus he said, The fourth beast shall be the fourth kingdom upon earth, which shall be diverse from all kingdoms, and shall devour the whole earth, and shall tread it down, and break it in pieces.

To Daniel was given a vision of fierce beasts, representing the powers of the earth.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 4, 1171

The Holy Spirit represents worldly kingdoms under the symbol of fierce beasts of prey.

Christ’s Object Lessons, 77

SYMBOLS USED FOR KINGDOMS

SUNDAY
26 July

What symbols represent the Roman Empire in its divided state? Daniel 7:7; Revelation 12:3

Daniel 7:7

After this I saw in the night visions, and behold a fourth beast, dreadful and terrible, and strong exceedingly; and it had great iron teeth: it devoured and brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with the feet of it: and it was diverse from all the beasts that were before it; and it had ten horns.

Revelation 12:3

And there appeared another wonder in heaven; and behold a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and seven crowns upon his heads.

The Great Controversy, 438

“The dragon is said to be Satan (Revelation 12:9); he it was that moved upon Herod to put the Saviour to death.”

The Great Controversy, 438

“the chief agent of Satan in making war upon Christ and His people during the first centuries of the Christian Era was the Roman Empire, in which paganism was the prevailing religion. Thus, while the dragon, primarily, represents Satan, it is, in a secondary sense, a symbol of pagan Rome.”

PAPAL ROME

MONDAY
27 July

What symbols stand for papal Rome?
Daniel 7:8, 24; Revelation 13:1, 2

Daniel 7:8

I considered the horns, and, behold, there came up among them another little horn, before whom there were three of the first horns plucked up by the roots: and, behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of man, and a mouth speaking great things.

Daniel 7:24

And the ten horns out of this kingdom are ten kings that shall arise: and another shall rise after them; and he shall be diverse from the first, and he shall subdue three kings.

Revelation 13:1

And I stood upon the sand of the sea, and saw a beast rise up out of the sea, having seven heads and ten horns, and upon his horns ten crowns, and upon his heads the name of blasphemy.

Revelation 13:2

And the beast which I saw was like unto a leopard, and his feet were as the feet of a bear, and his mouth as the mouth of a lion: and the dragon gave him his power, and his seat, and great authority.

The Great Controversy, 439

“In [Revelation] chapter 13 (verses 1–10) is described another beast, ‘like unto a leopard,’ to which the dragon gave ‘his power, and his seat, and great authority.’”

The Great Controversy, 439

“This symbol, as most Protestants have believed, represents the papacy, which succeeded to the power and seat and authority once held by the ancient Roman empire. Of the leopardlike beast it is declared: ‘There was given unto him a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies.”

The Great Controversy, 439

“And he opened his mouth in blasphemy against God, to blaspheme His name, and His tabernacle, and them that dwell in heaven. And it was given unto him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them: and power was given him over all kindreds, and tongues, and nations.’”

The Great Controversy, 439

“This prophecy, which is nearly identical with the description of the little horn of Daniel 7, unquestionably points to the papacy.”

PAPAL ROME

MONDAY
27 July

What was the predicted duration of the supremacy of papal Rome as a persecuting power? Daniel 7:25; Revelation 13:5, 7

Daniel 7:25

And shall wear out the saints of the most High, and think to change times and laws: and they shall be given into his hand until a time and times and the dividing of time.

Revelation 13:5

And there was given unto him a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies; and power was given unto him to continue forty and two months.

Revelation 13:7

And it was given unto him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them: and power was given him over all kindreds, and tongues, and nations.

The Great Controversy, 439

"'Power was given unto him to continue forty and two months.' And, says the prophet, 'I saw one of his heads as it were wounded to death.' And again: 'He that leadeth into captivity shall go into captivity: he that killeth with the sword must be killed with the sword.'"

The Great Controversy, 439

“The forty and two months are the same as the ‘time and times and the dividing of time,’ three years and a half, or 1260 days, of Daniel 7—the time during which the papal power was to oppress God’s people.”

The Great Controversy, 439

“This period, as stated in preceding chapters, began with the supremacy of the papacy, A.D. 538, and terminated in 1798.”

MAIN CHARACTERISTICS

TUESDAY
28 July

In what sense is Rome accused of uttering “great words”? Daniel 7:25, first part; Revelation 13:5, first part; 2 Thessalonians 2:3, 4, 7

Daniel 7:25

And he shall speak great words against the most High, and shall wear out the saints of the most High…



Revelation 13:5

And there was given unto him a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies;

2 Thessalonians 2:3

Let no man deceive you by any means: for that day shall not come, except there come a falling away first, and that man of sin be revealed, the son of perdition;

2 Thessalonians 2:4

Who opposeth and exalteth himself above all that is called God, or that is worshipped; so that he as God sitteth in the temple of God, shewing himself that he is God.

2 Thessalonians 2:7

For the mystery of iniquity doth already work: only he who now letteth will let, until he be taken out of the way.

The Great Controversy, 55

“The accession of the Roman Church to power marked the beginning of the Dark Ages. As her power increased, the darkness deepened. Faith was transferred from Christ, the true foundation, to the pope of Rome.”

The Great Controversy, 55

“Instead of trusting in the Son of God for forgiveness of sins and for eternal salvation, the people looked to the pope, and to the priests and prelates to whom he delegated authority.”

The Great Controversy, 55

“They were taught that the pope was their earthly mediator and that none could approach God except through him; and, further, that he stood in the place of God to them and was therefore to be implicitly obeyed.”

The Great Controversy, 55

“A deviation from his requirements was sufficient cause for the severest punishment to be visited upon the bodies and souls of the offenders.”

The Great Controversy, 55

“Thus, the minds of the people were turned away from God to fallible, erring, and cruel men, nay, more, to the prince of darkness himself, who exercised his power through them.”

The Great Controversy, 55

“Sin was disguised in a garb of sanctity. When the Scriptures are suppressed, and man comes to regard himself as supreme, we need look only for fraud, deception, and debasing iniquity.”

MAIN CHARACTERISTICS

TUESDAY
28 July

According to prophecy, what would Rome do with the law of God and with the truth in general? Daniel 7:25; 8:12

Daniel 7:25

And shall wear out the saints of the most High, and think to change times and laws:



Daniel 8:12

And an host was given him against the daily sacrifice by reason of transgression, and it cast down the truth to the ground; and it practised, and prospered.

The Great Controversy, 446

“The papacy has attempted to change the law of God. The second commandment, forbidding image worship, has been dropped from the law, and the fourth commandment has been so changed as to authorize the observance of the first instead of the seventh day as the Sabbath.”

The Great Controversy, 446

“But papists urge, as a reason for omitting the second commandment, that it is unnecessary, being included in the first, and that they are giving the law exactly as God designed it to be understood.”

The Great Controversy, 446

“This cannot be the change foretold by the prophet. An intentional, deliberate change is presented: ‘He shall think to change the times and the law.’ The change in the fourth commandment exactly fulfills the prophecy.”

The Great Controversy, 446

“For this the only authority claimed is that of the church. Here the papal power openly sets itself above God.”

THE DEADLY WOUND IS HEALED

WEDNESDAY

29 July

What is meant by the wounding of the head of the symbolic beast? Revelation 13:3

Revelation 13:3

And I saw one of his heads as it were wounded to death;



At that time [1798], the pope was made captive by the French army, the papal power received its deadly wound, and the prediction was fulfilled, 'He that leadeth into captivity shall go into captivity.'

The Great Controversy, 439

THE DEADLY WOUND IS HEALED

WEDNESDAY

29 July

What is meant by the healing of the wound? Revelation 13:3. How should this affect us personally?

Revelation 13:3

And his deadly wound was healed: and all the world wondered after the beast.

Selected Messages, Book 2, 367, 368

“The Scriptures teach that popery is to regain its lost supremacy, and that the fires of persecution will be rekindled through the time-serving concessions of the so-called Protestant world. In this time of peril, we can stand only as we have the truth and the power of God.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 367, 368

“Men can know the truth only by being themselves partakers of the divine nature. We have need now for more than human wisdom in reading and searching the Scriptures; and if we come to God’s Word with humble hearts, He will raise up a standard for us against the lawless element.”

THE BASIC AIM OF THE VATICAN

THURSDAY
30 July

cAs the political influence of the papacy is steadily increasing, what position will Rome reach before the whole world? Revelation 13:3, 8

Revelation 13:3, 8

And all the world wondered after the beast. And all that dwell upon the earth shall worship him, whose names are not written in the book of life of the Lamb slain from the foundation of the world.

The Great Controversy, 579, 580

“The influence of Rome in the countries that once acknowledged her dominion is still far from being destroyed. And prophecy foretells a restoration of her power. ‘I saw one of his heads as it were wounded to death; and his deadly wound was healed: and all the world wondered after the beast.’ Verse 3).”

The Great Controversy, 579, 580

“The infliction of the deadly wound points to the downfall of the papacy in 1798. After this, says the prophet, ‘his deadly wound was healed: and all the world wondered after the beast.’ Paul states plainly that the ‘man of sin’ will continue until the second advent.”

The Great Controversy, 579, 580

“ 2 Thessalonians 2:3–8. To the very close of time he will carry forward the work of deception. And the revelator declares, also referring to the papacy: ‘All that dwell upon the earth shall worship him, whose names are not written in the book of life.’ Revelation 13:8.”

The Great Controversy, 579, 580

“In both the Old and the New World, the papacy will receive homage in the honor paid to the Sunday institution, that rests solely upon the authority of the Roman Church.”

The Great Controversy, 579, 580

“Marvelous in her shrewdness and cunning is the Roman Church.”

The Great Controversy, 579, 580

“She can read what is to be. She bides her time, seeing that the Protestant churches are paying her homage in their acceptance of the false sabbath and that they are preparing to enforce it by the very means which she herself employed in bygone days.”

The Great Controversy, 579, 580

“Those who reject the light of truth will yet seek the aid of this self-styled infallible power to exalt an institution that originated with her.”

THE BASIC AIM OF THE VATICAN

THURSDAY
30 July

Under what other symbol is the growing power of the Roman Catholic Church also represented? Revelation 17:1, 9, 15, 18

Revelation 17:1

And there came one of the seven angels which had the seven vials, and talked with me, saying unto me, Come hither; I will shew unto thee the judgment of the great whore that sitteth upon many waters:

Revelation 17:9

And here is the mind which hath wisdom. The seven heads are seven mountains, on which the woman sitteth.

Revelation 17:15

And he saith unto me, The waters which thou sawest, where the whore sitteth, are peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues.

Revelation 17:18

And the woman which thou sawest is that great city, which reigneth over the kings of the earth.

The Great Controversy, 581

“Protestants little know what they are doing when they propose to accept the aid of Rome in the work of Sunday exaltation. While they are bent upon the accomplishment of their purpose, Rome is aiming to reestablish her power, to recover her lost supremacy.”

The Great Controversy, 581

“Let the principle once be established in the United States that the church may employ or control the power of the state; that religious observances may be enforced by secular laws; in short, that the authority of church and state is to dominate the conscience, and the triumph of Rome in this country is assured.”

God's word has given warning of the impending danger; let this be unheeded, and the Protestant world will learn what the purposes of Rome really are, only when it is too late to escape the snare.

The Great Controversy, 581

The Great Controversy, 581

“She is silently growing into power. Her doctrines are exerting their influence in legislative halls, in the churches, and in the hearts of men. She is piling up her lofty and massive structures in the secret recesses of which her former persecutions will be repeated.”

The Great Controversy, 581

“Stealthily and unsuspectedly she is strengthening her forces to further her own ends when the time shall come for her to strike. All that she desires is vantage ground, and this is already being given her.”

We shall soon see and shall feel what the purpose of the Roman element is. Whoever shall believe and obey the word of God will thereby incur reproach and persecution.

The Great Controversy, 581

REVIEW QUESTIONS

July 26 – August 1, 2026

1. What role did pagan Rome have in prophecy and history?
2. What do prophecy and history teach us about papal Rome?
3. Why is it necessary to point out warnings about the papal power?
4. What evidence do we have of the “healing” of the “deadly wound”?
5. How is the Protestant world now cooperating with Rome’s agenda?

THE LAMBLIKE BEAST

August 2 – 8, 2026



KEY TEXT

“And I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth; and he had two horns like a lamb, and he spake as a dragon.” Revelation 13:11

INTRODUCTION

“Prophecy represents Protestantism as having lamblike horns, but speaking like a dragon. Already we are beginning to hear the voice of the dragon.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 975

Study Help: The Great Controversy, 440–450; Seventh-day Adventist Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 975–977

A NEW POWER

SUNDAY
2 August

Besides the power represented by the first beast of Revelation 13, what other power did John see on the stage of history? Revelation 13:11

Revelation 13:11

And I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth...

The Great Controversy, 440

“But the beast with lamblike horns was seen ‘coming up out of the earth.’ Instead of overthrowing other powers to establish itself, the nation thus represented must arise in territory previously unoccupied and grow up gradually and peacefully.”

The Great Controversy, 440

“It could not, then, arise among the crowded and struggling nationalities of the Old World—that turbulent sea of ‘peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues.’ It must be sought in the Western Continent.”

The Great Controversy, 440

“What nation of the New World was in 1798 rising into power, giving promise of strength and greatness, and attracting the attention of the world? The application of the symbol admits of no question. One nation, and only one, meets the specifications of this prophecy; it points unmistakably to the United States of America.”

A NEW POWER

SUNDAY
2 August

What did the prophet record as the first notable feature of that second beast? Revelation 13:11

Revelation 13:11

And he had two horns like a lamb...



The Great Controversy, 441

“The lamblike horns indicate youth, innocence, and gentleness, fitly representing the character of the United States when presented to the prophet as ‘coming up’ in 1798.”

The Great Controversy, 441

“Among the Christian exiles who first fled to America and sought an asylum from royal oppression and priestly intolerance were many who determined to establish a government upon the broad foundation of civil and religious liberty.”

The Great Controversy, 441

“Their views found place in the Declaration of Independence, which sets forth the great truth that ‘all men are created equal’ and endowed with the inalienable right to ‘life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness.’”

The Great Controversy, 441

“And the Constitution guarantees to the people the right of self-government, providing that representatives elected by the popular vote shall enact and administer the laws. Freedom of religious faith was also granted, every man being permitted to worship God according to the dictates of his conscience.”

The Great Controversy, 441

“Republicanism and Protestantism became the fundamental principles of the nation. These principles are the secret of its power and prosperity.”

A SHOCKING CHARACTERISTIC

MONDAY
3 August

Since the second beast had shown lamblike innocence, what surprised John the Revelator? Revelation 13:11

Revelation 13:11

....and he spake as a dragon.



The Great Controversy, 442

“The lamblike horns and dragon voice of the symbol point to a striking contradiction between the professions and the practice of the nation thus represented.”

The Great Controversy, 442

“The ‘speaking’ of the nation is the action of its legislative and judicial authorities. By such action it will give the lie to those liberal and peaceful principles which it has put forth as the foundation of its policy.”

A SHOCKING CHARACTERISTIC

MONDAY
3 August

In what sense will the second beast imitate the first beast? Revelation 13:1

Revelation 13:1

And I stood upon the sand of the sea, and saw a beast rise up out of the sea, having seven heads and ten horns, and upon his horns ten crowns, and upon his heads the name of blasphemy.

The prediction that it will speak 'as a dragon' and exercise 'all the power of the first beast' plainly foretells a development of the spirit of intolerance and persecution that was manifested by the nations represented by the dragon and the leopardlike beast.

The Great Controversy, 442

AN “IMAGE” OF ROME

TUESDAY
4 August

What will the United States of America do to enforce homage to Rome? Revelation 13:12, last part

Revelation 13:12

And he exerciseth all the power of the first beast before him, and causeth the earth and them which dwell therein to worship the first beast...

The Great Controversy, 442

“The statement that the beast with two horns ‘causeth the earth and them which dwell therein to worship the first beast’ indicates that the authority of this nation is to be exercised in enforcing some observance which shall be an act of homage to the papacy.”

AN “IMAGE” OF ROME

TUESDAY
4 August

How will America not only imitate Rome but induce other nations to do the same? Describe the meaning of “making an image to the beast.” Revelation 13:14

Revelation 13:14

....Saying to them that dwell on the earth, that they should make an image to the beast, which had the wound by a sword, and did live.

As America, the land of religious liberty, shall unite with the papacy in forcing the conscience and compelling men to honor the false sabbath, the people of every country on the globe will be led to follow her example.

Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 6, 18

The Great Controversy, 445

“The ‘image to the beast’ represents that form of apostate Protestantism which will be developed when the Protestant churches shall seek the aid of the civil power for the enforcement of their dogmas.”

The Great Controversy, 445

“When the leading churches of the United States, uniting upon such points of doctrine as are held by them in common, shall influence the state to enforce their decrees and to sustain their institutions, then Protestant America will have formed an image of the Roman hierarchy, and the infliction of civil penalties upon dissenters will inevitably result.”

THE MARK OF THE BEAST

WEDNESDAY

5 August

Largely with the support of Protestant America, in what area will the encroachment of Rome upon human conscience become prominent? Revelation 13:16

Revelation 13:16

And he causeth all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads:

The Great Controversy, 445, 446

“After the warning against the worship of the beast and his image the prophecy declares: ‘Here are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of Jesus.’ Since those who keep God’s commandments are thus placed in contrast with those that worship the beast and his image and receive his mark, it follows that the keeping of God’s law, on the one hand, and its violation, on the other, will make the distinction between the worshipers of God and the worshipers of the beast.”

The Great Controversy, 449

“When Sunday observance shall be enforced by law, and the world shall be enlightened concerning the obligation of the true Sabbath, then whoever shall transgress the command of God, to obey a precept which has no higher authority than that of Rome, will thereby honor popery above God.”

The Great Controversy, 449

“He is paying homage to Rome and to the power which enforces the institution ordained by Rome. He is worshipping the beast and his image.”

The Great Controversy, 449

“As men then reject the institution which God has declared to be the sign of His authority, and honor in its stead that which Rome has chosen as the token of her supremacy, they will thereby accept the sign of allegiance to Rome—‘the mark of the beast.’”

The Great Controversy, 449

“And it is not until the issue is thus plainly set before the people, and they are brought to choose between the commandments of God and the commandments of men, that those who continue in transgression will receive ‘the mark of the beast.’”

THE MARK OF THE BEAST

WEDNESDAY

5 August

What will be imposed on those who refuse to accept the mark of the beast?
Revelation 13:17

Revelation 13:17

And that no man might buy or sell, save he that had the mark, or the name of the beast, or the number of his name.

The Desire of Ages, 121, 122

“In the last great conflict of the controversy with Satan those who are loyal to God will see every earthly support cut off. Because they refuse to break His law in obedience to earthly powers, they will be forbidden to buy or sell.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 4, 1171, 1172

“The Lord has clearly defined the road to the city of God; but the great apostate has changed the signpost, setting up a false one—a spurious sabbath. He says: ‘I will work at cross-purposes with God.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 4, 1171, 1172

“I will empower my delegate, the man of sin, to take down God’s memorial, the seventh-day Sabbath. … Human laws shall be made so stringent that men and women will not dare to observe the seventh-day Sabbath. For fear of wanting food and clothing, they will join with the world in transgressing God’s law.’ ”

THE DEATH DECREE

THURSDAY
6 August

In what way will Protestant America (the second beast) also imitate the most cruel aspects of the character of papal Rome (the first beast)? Revelation 13:15

Revelation 13:15

And he had power to give life unto the image of the beast, that the image of the beast should both speak, and cause that as many as would not worship the image of the beast should be killed.

The Great Controversy, 604

“Fearful is the issue to which the world is to be brought. The powers of earth, uniting to war against the commandments of God, will decree that ‘all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond’ (Revelation 13:16), shall conform to the customs of the church by the observance of the false sabbath.”

The Great Controversy, 604

“All who refuse compliance will be visited with civil penalties, and it will finally be declared that they are deserving of death. On the other hand, the law of God enjoining the Creator’s rest day demands obedience and threatens wrath against all who transgress its precepts.”

THE DEATH DECREE

THURSDAY

6 August

What advice should we take to heart in view of the time of trouble just before us? 1 Peter 3:14–17

1 Peter 3:14, 15

But and if ye suffer for righteousness' sake, happy are ye: and be not afraid of their terror, neither be troubled; But sanctify the Lord God in your hearts: and be ready always to give an answer to every man that asketh you a reason of the hope that is in you with meekness and fear:

1 Peter 3:16, 17

Having a good conscience; that, whereas they speak evil of you, as of evildoers, they may be ashamed that falsely accuse your good conversation in Christ. For it is better, if the will of God be so, that ye suffer for well doing, than for evil doing.

What course shall the advocates of truth pursue? They have the unchangeable, eternal word of God, and they should reveal the fact that they have the truth as it is in Jesus. Their words must not be rugged and sharp.

Evangelism, 236

In their presentation of truth, they must manifest the love and meekness and gentleness of Christ. Let the truth do the cutting; the word of God is as a sharp, two-edged sword, and will cut its way to the heart.

Evangelism, 236

Those who know that they have the truth should not, by the use of harsh and severe expressions, give Satan one chance to misinterpret their spirit.

Evangelism, 236

REVIEW QUESTIONS

August 2 – 8, 2026

1. What does the second beast represent, and how do we know this?
2. By what means does this lamblike beast adopt dragon-like traits?
3. How does the second beast begin to relate to the first beast?
4. What is the mark of the beast and why, ultimately, is it imposed?
5. In light of the approaching crisis, what should we bear in mind?

FALSE PROPHETS AND FALSE REVIVALS

August 9 – 15, 2026



KEY TEXT

“Let no man deceive you with vain words: for because of these things cometh the wrath of God upon the children of disobedience.”
Ephesians 5:6

INTRODUCTION

"Delusions and deceptions will come in among us, and will multiply as we near the end."
SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 952

Study Help: The Great Controversy, 471–478; Selected Messages, Book 2, 56–60

BEWARE!

SUNDAY
9 August

Why must we examine the spirit of professed religious teachers rather than blindly accept or reject evidences? 1 John 4:1; Acts 7:51

1 John 4:1

Beloved, believe not every spirit, but try the spirits whether they are of God: because many false prophets are gone out into the world.

Acts 7:51

Ye stiffnecked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, ye do always resist the Holy Ghost: as your fathers did, so do ye.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 951

“In these days of peril we are not to accept everything that men bring to us as truth. As professed teachers from God come to us declaring that they have a message from God, it is proper to inquire carefully, How do we know that this is truth?”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 951

“Jesus has told us that ‘false prophets shall rise and shall deceive many.’ But we need not be deceived; for the word of God gives us a test whereby we may know what is truth. The prophet says, ‘To the law and to the testimony: if they speak not according to this word, it is because there is no light in them.’”

BEWARE!

SUNDAY
9 August

What danger has always surrounded the people of God? Jeremiah 14:14; 23:21; 2 Peter 2:1

Jeremiah 14:14

Then the LORD said unto me, The prophets prophesy lies in my name: I sent them not, neither have I commanded them, neither spake unto them: they prophesy unto you a false vision and divination, and a thing of nought, and the deceit of their heart.

Jeremiah 23:21

I have not sent these prophets, yet they ran: I have not spoken to them, yet they prophesied.

2 Peter 2:1

But there were false prophets also among the people, even as there shall be false teachers among you, who privily shall bring in damnable heresies, even denying the Lord that bought them, and bring upon themselves swift destruction.

Evangelism, 359

“Christ foretold that the going forth of deceivers would be accompanied with more danger to His disciples than would persecution. … The effort of seducers has been to undermine confidence in the truth of God and to make it impossible to distinguish truth from error.”

Evangelism, 359

“Wonderfully pleasing, fanciful, scientific problems are introduced and urged upon the attention of the unwary; and unless believers are on their guard, the enemy, disguised as an angel of light, will lead them into false paths.”

MIRACULOUS HEALING

MONDAY
10 August

Through what means will Satan deceive many souls who have no background in the truth? 2 Kings 1:2; Acts 8:9–11

2 Kings 1:2

And Ahaziah fell down through a lattice in his upper chamber that was in Samaria, and was sick: and he sent messengers, and said unto them, Go, enquire of Baalzebub the god of Ekron whether I shall recover of this disease.

Acts 8:9, 10

But there was a certain man, called Simon, which beforetime in the same city used sorcery, and bewitched the people of Samaria, giving out that himself was some great one: To whom they all gave heed, from the least to the greatest, saying, This man is the great power of God.

Acts 8:11

And to him they had regard, because that of long time he had bewitched them with sorceries.

Prophets and Kings, 211

“The apostles of nearly all forms of spiritism claim to have power to heal. They attribute this power to electricity, magnetism, the so-called ‘sympathetic remedies,’ or to latent forces within the mind of man.”

Prophets and Kings, 211

“And there are not a few, even in this Christian age, who go to these healers, instead of trusting in the power of the living God and the skill of well qualified physicians.”

Prophets and Kings, 211

“The mother, watching by the sickbed of her child, exclaims, ‘I can do no more. Is there no physician who has power to restore my child?’”

Prophets and Kings, 211

“She is told of the wonderful cures performed by some clairvoyant or magnetic healer, and she trusts her dear one to his charge, placing it as verily in the hand of Satan as if he were standing by her side. In many instances the future life of the child is controlled by a satanic power which it seems impossible to break.”

MIRACULOUS HEALING

MONDAY
10 August

What danger lies before those who are not anchored in Christ? 2 Thessalonians 2:9, 10. What standard of righteousness is ignored by false prophets? Romans 8:4, 7

2 Thessalonians 2:9, 10

Even him, whose coming is after the working of Satan with all power and signs and lying wonders, And with all deceivableness of unrighteousness in them that perish; because they received not the love of the truth, that they might be saved.

Romans 8:4, 7

That the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit. Because the carnal mind is enmity against God: for it is not subject to the law of God, neither indeed can be.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 5, 1099

“Many make great pretensions to holiness, and boast of the wonders they perform in healing the sick, when they do not regard this great standard of righteousness.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 5, 1099

“But through whose power are these cures wrought? Are the eyes of either party opened to their transgressions of the law? and do they take their stand as humble, obedient children, ready to obey all of God’s requirements?”

DISCERNING BETWEEN RIGHT AND WRONG

TUESDAY
11 August

Before the Holy Spirit is poured out in fullness, how will Satan try to counterfeit the work of God? Matthew 7:22

Matthew 7:22

Many will say to me in that day, Lord, Lord, have we not prophesied in thy name? and in thy name have cast out devils? and in thy name done many wonderful works?

The Great Controversy, 464

“Before the final visitation of God’s judgments upon the earth there will be among the people of the Lord such a revival of primitive godliness as has not been witnessed since apostolic times. The Spirit and power of God will be poured out upon His children.”

The Great Controversy, 464

“At that time many will separate themselves from those churches in which the love of this world has supplanted love for God and His word. Many, both of ministers and people, will gladly accept those great truths which God has caused to be proclaimed at this time to prepare a people for the Lord’s second coming.”

The Great Controversy, 464

“The enemy of souls desires to hinder this work; and before the time for such a movement shall come, he will endeavor to prevent it by introducing a counterfeit.”

The Great Controversy, 464

“In those churches which he can bring under his deceptive power he will make it appear that God’s special blessing is poured out; there will be manifest what is thought to be great religious interest. Multitudes will exult that God is working marvelously for them, when the work is that of another spirit.”

DISCERNING BETWEEN RIGHT AND WRONG

TUESDAY
11 August

What discernment do we need when faced by the confusion introduced by the enemy of souls? Hebrews 5:14. How does this relate to our health message and medical missionary work?

Hebrews 5:14

But strong meat belongeth to them that are of full age, even those who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil.

Selected Messages, Book 2, 54

“The way in which Christ worked was to preach the Word, and to relieve suffering by miraculous works of healing. But I am instructed that we cannot now work in this way, for Satan will exercise his power by working miracles.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 54

“God’s servants today could not work by means of miracles, because spurious works of healing, claiming to be divine, will be wrought.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 54

“For this reason, the Lord has marked out a way in which His people are to carry forward a work of physical healing, combined with the teaching of the Word.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 54

“Sanitariums are to be established, and with these institutions are to be connected workers who will carry forward genuine medical missionary work. Thus, a guarding influence is thrown around those who come to the sanitariums for treatment.”

“BY THEIR FRUITS”

WEDNESDAY

12 August

Why will God’s remnant people not be deceived by modern revivals and spurious miracles? 1 Corinthians 12:10; Ephesians 1:17, 18

1 Corinthians 12:10

To another the working of miracles; to another prophecy; to another discerning of spirits; to another divers kinds of tongues; to another the interpretation of tongues:

Ephesians 1:17, 18

That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give unto you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him: The eyes of your understanding being enlightened; that ye may know what is the hope of his calling, and what the riches of the glory of his inheritance in the saints,

The Great Controversy, 464

“In many of the revivals which have occurred during the last half century, the same influences have been at work, to a greater or less degree, that will be manifest in the more extensive movements of the future.”

The Great Controversy, 464

“There is an emotional excitement, a mingling of the true with the false, that is well adapted to mislead. Yet none need be deceived. In the light of God’s word, it is not difficult to determine the nature of these movements.”

The Great Controversy, 464

“Wherever men neglect the testimony of the Bible, turning away from those plain, soul-testing truths which require self-denial and renunciation of the world, there we may be sure that God’s blessing is not bestowed.”

“BY THEIR FRUITS”

WEDNESDAY

12 August

**While we should avoid a judgmental spirit (Matthew 7:1, 2), what enables us to face Satan’s subtleties?
Matthew 24:4; 1 John 2:3–5**

Matthew 24:4

And Jesus answered and said unto them, Take heed that no man deceive you.

1 John 2:3, 4

And hereby we do know that we know him, if we keep his commandments. He that saith, I know him, and keepeth not his commandments, is a liar, and the truth is not in him.

1 John 2:5

But whoso keepeth his word, in him verily is the love of God perfected: hereby know we that we are in him.

Selected Messages, Book 2, 98, 99

“In these days of delusion, everyone who is established in the truth will have to contend for the faith once delivered to the saints. Every variety of error will be brought out in the mysterious working of Satan, which would, if it were possible, deceive the very elect, and turn them from the truth.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 98, 99

“There will be human wisdom to meet—the wisdom of learned men, who, as were the Pharisees, are teachers of the law of God, but do not obey the law themselves.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 98, 99

“There will be human ignorance and folly to meet in disconnected theories arrayed in new and fantastic dress—theories that it will be all the more difficult to meet because there is no reason in them.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 98, 99

“There will be false dreams and false visions, which have some truth, but lead away from the original faith. The Lord has given men a rule by which to detect them: ‘To the law and to the testimony: if they speak not according to this word, it is because there is no light in them’ (Isaiah 8:20).”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 98, 99

“If they belittle the law of God, if they pay no heed to His will as revealed in the testimonies of His Spirit, they are deceivers. They are controlled by impulse and impressions, which they believe to be from the Holy Spirit, and consider more reliable than the Inspired Word.”

Selected Messages, Book 2, 98, 99

“They claim that every thought and feeling is an impression of the Spirit; and when they are reasoned with out of the Scriptures, they declare that they have something more reliable. But while they think that they are led by the Spirit of God, they are in reality following an imagination wrought upon by Satan.”

THE GREATEST COUNTERFEIT

THURSDAY
13 August

What will be the climax in Satan's deceptions? Matthew 24:23

Matthew 24:23

Then if any man shall say unto you, Lo, here is Christ, or there; believe it not.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 5, 1105, 1106

“The conflict is not yet ended; and as we draw near the close of time, the battle waxes more intense. As the second appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ draws near, satanic agencies are moved from beneath.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 5, 1105, 1106

“Satan will not only appear as a human being, but he will personate Jesus Christ; and the world that has rejected the truth will receive him as the Lord of lords and King of kings. He will exercise his power, and work upon the human imagination.”

THE GREATEST COUNTERFEIT

THURSDAY
13 August

In the final crisis, on what basis must we test every miracle, every claim, and every doctrine? James 1:22–25; Isaiah 8:20

James 1:22, 23

But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves. For if any be a hearer of the word, and not a doer, he is like unto a man beholding his natural face in a glass:

James 1:24, 25

For he beholdeth himself, and goeth his way, and straightway forgetteth what manner of man he was. But whoso looketh into the perfect law of liberty, and continueth therein, he being not a forgetful hearer, but a doer of the work, this man shall be blessed in his deed.

Isaiah 8:20

To the law and to the testimony: if they speak not according to this word, it is because there is no light in them.

At every revival of God's work the prince of evil is aroused to more intense activity; he is now putting forth his utmost efforts for a final struggle against Christ and His followers. The last great delusion is soon to open before us.

The Great Controversy, 593

Antichrist is to perform his marvelous works in our sight. So closely will the counterfeit resemble the true that it will be impossible to distinguish between them except by the Holy Scriptures. By their testimony every statement and every miracle must be tested.

The Great Controversy, 593

REVIEW QUESTIONS

August 9 – 15, 2026

1. Why are we called to be on guard in these last days?
2. Explain the dangers of spiritistic and “New Age” health practitioners.
3. Describe the strategy which the enemy of souls is soon to unleash.
4. How can we discern between the miracles of God and those of Satan?
5. What is our only safeguard against Satan’s greatest delusion?

PREPARING FOR THE CRISIS

August 16 – 22, 2026



KEY TEXT

“Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.” Ephesians 6:13

INTRODUCTION

"Search the Scriptures for yourselves, that you may understand the fearful solemnity of the present hour."
Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 5, 216

Study Help: Testimonies for the Church, Vol. 5, 199–202; Testimonies to Ministers, 516–520

OUR GREATEST CONCERN

SUNDAY
16 August

What should be our greatest concern while the door of probation is still open?
Acts 16:30; Matthew 16:26

Acts 16:30

And brought them out, and said, Sirs, what must I do to be saved?

Matthew 16:26

For what is a man profited, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul? or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?

Selected Messages, Book 1, 56

“Are our people reviewing the past and the present and the future, as it is unfolding before the world? Are they heeding the messages of warning given them?”

Selected Messages, Book 1, 56

“Is it our greatest concern today that our lives shall be refined and purified, and that we shall reflect the similitude of the divine? This must be the experience of all who join that company who are washed and made white in the blood of the Lamb.”

OUR GREATEST CONCERN

SUNDAY
16 August

What is the secret to gaining spiritual victory? Hebrews 12:2

Hebrews 12:2

Looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith; who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God.

Testimonies, Vol. 5, 199, 200

“Many make a serious mistake in their religious life by keeping the attention fixed upon their feelings and thus judging of their advancement or decline. Feelings are not a safe criterion. We are not to look within for evidence of our acceptance with God.”

Testimonies, Vol. 5, 199, 200

“We shall find there nothing but that which will discourage us. Our only hope is in ‘looking unto Jesus the Author and Finisher of our faith.’ There is everything in Him to inspire with hope, with faith, and with courage. He is our righteousness, our consolation and rejoicing.”

We must look to Christ for strength and grace, and we shall gain the victory as surely as Jesus died for us.

The Sanctified Life, 93

THE NEEDED ASSURANCE

MONDAY
17 August

What assurance should we seek every morning? Exodus 33:14, 15

Exodus 33:14, 15

And he said, My presence shall go with thee, and I will give thee rest.5 And he said unto him, If thy presence go not with me, carry us not up hence.

The Acts of the Apostles, 56

“Morning by morning, as the heralds of the gospel kneel before the Lord and renew their vows of consecration to Him, He will grant them the presence of His Spirit, with its reviving, sanctifying power.”

The Acts of the Apostles, 56

“As they go forth to the day’s duties, they have the assurance that the unseen agency of the Holy Spirit enables them to be ‘laborers together with God.’”

THE NEEDED ASSURANCE

MONDAY
17 August

How can we obtain this assurance? Luke 18:7, 8. Under what conditions are we in danger of forfeiting God's presence?

Luke 18:7, 8

And shall not God avenge his own elect, which cry day and night unto him, though he bear long with them? I tell you that he will avenge them speedily. Nevertheless when the Son of man cometh, shall he find faith on the earth?

The Desire of Ages, 324

“It is not necessary for us deliberately to choose the service of the kingdom of darkness in order to come under its dominion. We have only to neglect to ally ourselves with the kingdom of light. If we do not cooperate with the heavenly agencies, Satan will take possession of the heart, and will make it his abiding place.”

The Desire of Ages, 324

“The only defense against evil is the indwelling of Christ in the heart through faith in His righteousness. Unless we become vitally connected with God, we can never resist the unhallowed effects of self-love, self-indulgence, and temptation to sin.”

The Desire of Ages, 324

“We may leave off many bad habits, for the time we may part company with Satan; but without a vital connection with God, through the surrender of ourselves to Him moment by moment, we shall be overcome.”

The Desire of Ages, 324

“Without a personal acquaintance with Christ, and a continual communion, we are at the mercy of the enemy, and shall do his bidding in the end.”

It is now that we are to learn [the] lesson of prevailing prayer, of unyielding faith. The greatest victories to the church of Christ or to the individual Christian are not those that are gained by talent or education, by wealth or the favor of men.

Patriarchs and Prophets, 203

They are those victories that are gained in the audience chamber with God, when earnest, agonizing faith lays hold upon the mighty arm of power.

Patriarchs and Prophets, 203

HOW WE ARE ENABLED TO STAND

TUESDAY
18 August

What would we see and do without delay if our eyes could be opened? Ephesians 6:12–18. Who only will be able to stand in the last great conflict?

Ephesians 6:12, 13

For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places. Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.

Ephesians 6:14–16

Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness; And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace; Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked.

Ephesians 6:17, 18

And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God: Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, and watching thereunto with all perseverance and supplication for all saints;

Testimonies, Vol. 6, 41

“If our eyes could be opened to see the good and evil agencies at work, there would be no trifling, no vanity, no jesting or joking. If all would put on the whole armor of God and fight manfully the battles of the Lord, victories would be gained that would cause the kingdom of darkness to tremble.”

None but those who have fortified the mind with the truths of the Bible will stand through the last great conflict.

The Great Controversy, 593, 594

HOW WE ARE ENABLED TO STAND

TUESDAY
18 August

As we bear the whole armor of God, what position and action will make us victorious in the spiritual battle?
James 4:7, 8

James 4:7, 8

Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you. Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you. Cleanse your hands, ye sinners; and purify your hearts, ye double minded.

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 937

“The soul that loves God, loves to draw strength from Him by constant communion with Him. When it becomes the habit of the soul to converse with God, the power of the evil one is broken; for Satan cannot abide near the soul that draws nigh unto God.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 937

“ ‘Draw nigh to God.’ What is the result of this? We cannot draw nigh to God and behold His loveliness and compassion without realizing our defects and being filled with a desire to rise higher.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 937

"'And he will draw nigh to you.' The Lord will draw nigh to him who confesses to his brethren the wrongs he has done them, and then comes to God in humility and contrition."

Prophets and Kings, 74

“The forces of the enemy of all righteousness are strongly entrenched; only by the power of God can the victory be gained. The conflict before us calls for the exercise of a spirit of self-denial, for distrust of self and for dependence on God alone, for the wise use of every opportunity for the saving of souls.”

Prophets and Kings, 74

“The Lord’s blessing will attend His church as they advance unitedly, revealing to a world lying in the darkness of error the beauty of holiness as manifested in a Christlike spirit of self-sacrifice, in an exaltation of the divine rather than the human, and in loving and untiring service for those so much in need of the blessings of the gospel.”

SALVATION, A JOINT OPERATION

WEDNESDAY

19 August

**In cooperation with divine strength, what is absolutely necessary if we would be victors? Philippians 2:12, 13;
2 Corinthians 7:1; 1 John 3:3**

Philippians 2:12, 13

Wherefore, my beloved, as ye have always obeyed, not as in my presence only, but now much more in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling. For it is God which worketh in you both to will and to do of his good pleasure.

2 Corinthians 7:1

Having therefore these promises, dearly beloved, let us cleanse ourselves from all filthiness of the flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God.

1 John 3:3

And every man that hath this hope in him purifieth himself, even as he is pure.

No one of us will gain the victory without persevering, untiring effort, proportionate to the value of the object which we seek, even eternal life.

Testimonies to Ministers, 511

Testimonies, Vol. 4, 33

“God cannot save man against his will from the power of Satan’s artifices. Man must work with his human power, aided by the divine power of Christ, to resist and to conquer at any cost to himself. In short, man must overcome as Christ overcame.”

Testimonies, Vol. 4, 33

“And then, through the victory that it is his privilege to gain by the all-powerful name of Jesus, he may become an heir of God and joint heir with Jesus Christ. This could not be the case if Christ alone did all the overcoming.”

Testimonies, Vol. 4, 33

“Man must do his part; he must be victor on his own account, through the strength and grace that Christ gives him. Man must be a coworker with Christ in the labor of overcoming, and then he will be partaker with Christ of His glory.”

SALVATION, A JOINT OPERATION

WEDNESDAY

19 August

How does the apostle Paul describe his efforts in the interest of his own salvation? 1 Corinthians 9:25–27; 15:31; 2 Timothy 4:7, 8

1 Corinthians 9:25, 26

And every man that striveth for the mastery is temperate in all things. Now they do it to obtain a corruptible crown; but we an incorruptible. I therefore so run, not as uncertainly; so fight I, not as one that beateth the air:

1 Corinthians 9:27

But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection: lest that by any means, when I have preached to others, I myself should be a castaway.

1 Corinthians 15:31

I protest by your rejoicing which I have in Christ Jesus our Lord, I die daily.

2 Timothy 4:7, 8

I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith: Henceforth there is laid up for me a crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous judge, shall give me at that day: and not to me only, but unto all them also that love his appearing.

Paul attained to the full moral stature of a man in Christ Jesus. By what a process was his soul developed! His life was a continual scene of hardship, conflict, and toil.

Seventh-day Adventist Bible Commentary, Vol. 7, 903

VICTORY WITHIN OUR REACH

THURSDAY
20 August

How does the apostle summarize the essentials of a victorious Christian life? Colossians 1:23, 27; Galatians 2:20; Titus 2:11–14. Why must we examine ourselves daily? 2 Corinthians 13:5

Colossians 1:23

If ye continue in the faith grounded and settled, and be not moved away from the hope of the gospel, which ye have heard, and which was preached to every creature which is under heaven; whereof I Paul am made a minister;

Colossians 1:27

To whom God would make known what is the riches of the glory of this mystery among the Gentiles; which is Christ in you, the hope of glory:

Galatians 2:20

I am crucified with Christ: nevertheless I live; yet not I, but Christ liveth in me: and the life which I now live in the flesh I live by the faith of the Son of God, who loved me, and gave himself for me.

Titus 2:11, 12

For the grace of God that bringeth salvation hath appeared to all men, Teaching us that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we should live soberly, righteously, and godly, in this present world;

Titus 2:13, 14

Looking for that blessed hope, and the glorious appearing of the great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ; Who gave himself for us, that he might redeem us from all iniquity, and purify unto himself a peculiar people, zealous of good works.

2 Corinthians 13:5

Examine yourselves, whether ye be in the faith; prove your own selves. Know ye not your own selves, how that Jesus Christ is in you, except ye be reprobates?

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 6, 1120

“Who is it that is ruling the world today, and who is it that have chosen to stand under the banner of the prince of darkness? Why, it is nearly the whole world at large.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 6, 1120

“All the world that have not accepted Jesus Christ have chosen for their leader the prince of darkness; and just as soon as they stand under his banner, they have connection with evil angels. Either the evil angels or the angels of God are controlling the minds of men.”

SDA Bible Commentary, Vol. 6, 1120

“Our minds are given to the control of God, or to the control of the powers of darkness; and it will be well for us to inquire where we are standing today—whether under the blood-stained banner of Prince Emmanuel, or under the black banner of the powers of darkness.”

VICTORY WITHIN OUR REACH

THURSDAY
20 August

What work is to be done by the Holy Spirit, through us, in behalf of the world? John 16:8

John 16:8

And when he is come, he will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment:

The Holy Spirit enabled the disciples to exalt the Lord alone, and guided the pens of the sacred historians, that the record of the words and works of Christ might be given to the world.

Gospel Workers, 286

Today this Spirit is constantly at work, seeking to draw the attention of men to the great sacrifice made upon the cross of Calvary, to unfold to the world the love of God to man, and to open to the convicted soul the promises of the Scriptures.

Gospel Workers, 286

REVIEW QUESTIONS

August 16 – 22, 2026

1. What is our greatest need today and how can it be fulfilled?
2. Why is an active prayer life essential?
3. How are we to draw nigh unto God—and what will be the results?
4. What should we learn from the daily life of the apostle Paul?
5. How only can the world be warned today?